

ENGLISH FOR EVIDENCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Legal Operations and Compliance English

Clarify the request. Preserve the evidence.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For legal operations specialists, compliance coordinators, contract administrators, privacy teams, and governance professionals.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight lessons connect requests, controls, evidence, privacy, vendors, training, and governance. Three additional conversations cover outside-counsel billing, preservation, and contract notice.

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Precise records. Responsible decisions.

Legal operations and compliance teams connect business requests, evidence, specialists, and authorized decisions. These conversations practice clear handoffs and careful distinctions without turning an incomplete record into a legal conclusion or a completed control.

Name the status

Received, assigned, reviewed, approved, signed, implemented, and verified describe different events. Use the status supported by the record and identify what must happen next.

"The plan is approved; implementation evidence is still outstanding."

Keep the source attached to the claim

Separate a reported observation, an interpretation, a document, and an established finding. Attribution makes a record fairer and more useful for qualified review.

"The reporter says the invoice was approved early; the motive has not been established."

Match evidence to the question

A current screenshot cannot automatically prove how a control operated in an earlier period. State the source, period, version, completeness, and any known gap.

"This image shows the current setting, not the requested January-to-March operation."

Coordinate without inventing authority

Make the route and next contact clear. Operational urgency does not confer legal, privacy, investigation, or risk-acceptance authority on the person receiving the request.

"I can coordinate the review; the designated reviewer must decide the exception."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All organizations, people, policies, thresholds, cases, and timelines are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal advice or a complete compliance program. Follow current applicable law, actual policies, retention and preservation duties, and qualified legal or privacy guidance. Source jurisdictions differ; no example creates a universal rule, deadline, privilege, or legal conclusion.

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

A Read the situation

Clarify the agreement, owner, decision need, and document status before routing a contract request.

Ben submits request L17 with the subject Urgent contract. It lacks an agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Attached is an unsigned vendor service proposal for a two-month, \$40,000 software pilot; an earlier nondisclosure agreement is also attached. Intake coordinator Mina must establish the transaction purpose, correct parties, required documents, personal-data involvement, and actual timing. Receipt is not legal approval. The business has not confirmed who can authorize spending or sign. Mina can coordinate triage but cannot decide contract terms or promise immediate signature.

PEOPLE / Ben: Business requester | Mina: Legal intake coordinator

CLARIFICATION CAN BE HELPFUL UNDER TIME PRESSURE

A requester may hear questions as delay. Explain which missing facts let the team assign the right reviewer and distinguish a business decision deadline from a hoped-for signature. Acknowledge urgency without promising that required review can be skipped.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which information is missing from intake?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| A Every attached document | B The fact that a pilot is proposed |
| C The quoted pilot amount | D Agreement type, business owner, and required decision date |

2. What does the service proposal describe?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A A two-month software pilot for \$40,000 | B An already signed annual license |
| C A completed legal approval | D A nondisclosure agreement with no services |

3. What can Mina do?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Coordinate triage and route the request | B Approve legal terms without review |
| C Sign for the business automatically | D Convert urgency into spending authority |

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

intake

Receiving and organizing information needed to handle a request.

IN USE complete contract intake

matter

A legal or operational issue tracked as a defined item of work.

IN USE open a matter

triage

Assessing a request to determine its route, priority, and next action.

IN USE triage the request

business owner

The person accountable for the underlying business need.

IN USE identify the business owner

requester

The person submitting a request, not necessarily its decision-maker.

IN USE contact the requester

counterparty

The other party to the relevant agreement or transaction.

IN USE verify the counterparty

legal entity

An organization or person recognized as capable of relevant legal rights and duties.

IN USE confirm the legal entity

agreement type

The category of contract or document being requested.

IN USE identify the agreement type

NDA

Nondisclosure agreement; terms governing specified confidential information.

IN USE locate the NDA

MSA

Master services agreement; overarching terms for specified service arrangements.

IN USE review the MSA

SOW

Statement of work; a document specifying particular work and related terms.

IN USE reconcile the SOW

order form

A document setting out a particular purchase and its relevant terms.

IN USE verify the order form

Precision check

The earlier NDA and the proposed services arrangement serve different purposes. Do not assume the NDA approves the pilot, spending, data processing, or signature. Reviewers need the relevant document package and actual parties, not an intake label alone.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

contract package

The related documents that together describe the proposed arrangement.

IN USE assemble the contract package

unsigned proposal

Proposed terms that have not been signed in the supplied record.

IN USE identify an unsigned proposal

signature authority

Permission to execute the relevant agreement on behalf of a party.

IN USE verify signature authority

spend approval

Authorization to commit the relevant funds.

IN USE obtain spend approval

decision deadline

The time by which a specified decision is needed.

IN USE clarify the decision deadline

target signature date

A desired signing date whose commitment status must be clear.

IN USE qualify the target signature date

review scope

The issues and documents included in an assessment.

IN USE define the review scope

routing rule

A criterion determining where a request is sent.

IN USE apply routing rules

CLM

Contract lifecycle management; processes and systems for managing contract stages.

IN USE maintain the CLM record

version control

Management of document revisions and their status.

IN USE maintain version control

turnaround estimate

An estimate of how long a defined response or task will take.

IN USE qualify the turnaround estimate

legal approval

Approval within the defined legal review process, distinct from other authorizations.

IN USE record legal approval

Precision check

The required decision date and the target signature date may differ. Acknowledgment means the request was received. Triage, legal review, commercial approval, and execution have separate statuses and authorities; a system entry does not complete all of them.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"I have received L17 and the attached proposal."

CLARIFY THE TRANSACTION

"What services will the two-month pilot actually include?"

SEPARATE THE DOCUMENTS

"The earlier NDA does not replace the service documents."

CHECK AUTHORITY

"Who approves the spend, and who is authorized to sign?"

EXPLAIN THE MISSING FACTS

"To route it correctly, I need the agreement type, business owner, and decision date."

VERIFY THE PARTIES

"Which legal entities would enter the agreement?"

IDENTIFY THE OWNER

"Who is accountable for the business need?"

CLARIFY URGENCY

"What decision is needed by what date, and what happens if it is delayed?"

To route it correctly

Explains why the question matters to the requester's progress.

Which entities

Distinguishes legal parties from brands or informal team names.

Does not replace

Separates the roles of related contract documents.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE TWO DATES

"Is that the review deadline or the desired signature date?"

KEEP STATUS ACCURATE

"The proposal is unsigned and has not completed review."

AVOID A TURNAROUND PROMISE

"We need the scope and reviewer availability before confirming timing."

MAINTAIN ONE RECORD

"Keep the current version and status in the intake record."

CHECK DATA INVOLVEMENT

"Will the pilot involve personal data or access to customer systems?"

REQUEST THE PACKAGE

"Please include the current proposal and all referenced terms."

ROUTE SPECIALIST QUESTIONS

"I will flag the data-processing details for the appropriate reviewer."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I will confirm the route, missing items, and next contact once triage is complete."

What decision

Makes urgency specific enough to prioritize responsibly.

Has not completed

States review status without declaring the proposal unacceptable.

Once triage is complete

Sets a process boundary without promising the substantive result.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which acknowledgment is accurate?

- A** L17 is legally approved because the file uploaded successfully.
- B** The old NDA authorizes the pilot spend.
- C** The requester may sign because the request is urgent.
- D** L17 is received; routing information and required approvals remain outstanding.

2. Which question clarifies timing best?

- A** Shall we estimate turnaround from the amount before confirming scope?
- B** What decision is needed by which date, and how does that differ from desired signature?
- C** Shall I use the desired signing date as the only review deadline?
- D** Can I use the supplier's reminder date without checking the business decision?

3. What should the reviewer receive?

- A** The current proposal, referenced terms, party details, business purpose, and relevant data information
- B** Only the subject line
- C** An older NDA instead of the current services documents
- D** A rewritten summary concealing unresolved terms

4. Which distinction is necessary?

- A** Requester, business owner, spend approver, and signer may be different roles.
- B** Every requester is automatically the authorized signer.
- C** Legal approval always approves the budget.
- D** A CLM record is equivalent to an executed contract.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Urgent is a signal, not a complete instruction

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

legal entity / turnaround estimate / version control / signature authority / triage / NDA / decision deadline / review scope / business owner / intake

- 01 **Ben:** I marked L17 urgent. The supplier is waiting, and the business wants the software pilot moving this week.
- 02 **Mina:** To complete ¹ _____, I need the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date. Those details help us assign the right reviewer without unnecessary transfers.
- 03 **Ben:** The proposal is for a two-month pilot costing forty thousand dollars. I attached the confidentiality agreement we signed earlier as well.
- 04 **Mina:** Thank you. The ² _____ and the pilot services arrangement have different purposes. We need the current proposal and any referenced service terms, rather than treat the earlier confidentiality document as approval of the whole purchase.
- 05 **Ben:** I submitted it for Nell in operations. She owns the pilot objective, although I do not know who approves the final spend.
- 06 **Mina:** I will record Nell as the ³ _____ and leave the spend approver unconfirmed. The person who requests work, the person who owns the need, and the person who can authorize it are not necessarily the same.
- 07 **Ben:** The slides say Orbit; the proposal has a longer company name. I nearly shortened it to match. Should I leave it as written?
- 08 **Mina:** We need the actual ⁴ _____ for each side. Please preserve the name in the document and have the business confirm the intended parties, rather than replace a formal name with the brand from the slides.
- 09 **Ben:** Nell needs a decision about whether to proceed by the sixth of October at noon UTC. She hopes to sign by the ninth.
- 10 **Mina:** That gives us a specific ⁵ _____ and a separate target signature date. I will record both and the business consequence of delay, but those dates do not establish reviewer availability or approval.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Ben:** The pilot will use customer contact details. I am not sure whether the supplier only views them or also stores a copy.
- 12 **Mina:** Include that uncertainty in the ⁶ _____. The data flow and access details may affect which specialists need to review. Please do not answer stored or not stored merely to make the form look complete.
- 13 **Ben:** There are two versions of the proposal in the email chain. The latest changes the support arrangement, but neither is signed.
- 14 **Mina:** Keep clear ⁷ _____. Identify the current revision and preserve the relevant history so the reviewer sees the changed support terms rather than an outdated attachment.
- 15 **Ben:** Once the legal team reviews it, can I send it for signature, or should I wait for another approval?
- 16 **Mina:** We must verify ⁸ _____ and the other required approvals. Legal review does not automatically approve the budget or make you the signer. The actual workflow will identify the necessary sequence.
- 17 **Ben:** The supplier keeps chasing. Could we say today, even though the reviewer is not confirmed?
- 18 **Mina:** I cannot give that ⁹ _____ yet. I can acknowledge receipt and confirm that we are clarifying the route. Once the scope and reviewer availability are known, we can communicate a supported timing expectation.
- 19 **Ben:** I will get Nell's confirmation, the party details, the latest proposal, and the data-handling information into the same record.
- 20 **Mina:** Good. I will complete ¹⁰ _____, identify the missing approvals, and confirm the next contact. We can respond to the urgency while keeping receipt, review, approval, and signature as separate statuses.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. intake | 2. NDA | 3. business owner | 4. legal entity | 5. decision deadline | 6. review scope | 7. version control | 8. signature authority | 9. turnaround estimate | 10. triage

Clarify another urgent intake request

F Say it

Request M22 attaches an unsigned services proposal. Dana owns the business need. A review decision is needed on 5 May; signature is desired on 9 May. The spend approver and authorized signer are not yet confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Dana / unsigned / unconfirmed / 5 May

Coordinator: "The document status is ¹ _____."

Requester: "The business owner is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The decision is needed on ³ _____."

Requester: "The signer remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. unsigned | 2. Dana | 3. 5 May | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Ben and Mina aloud, then swap roles. Separate the sixth-of-October decision from the hoped-for ninth-of-October signature.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Reread the party-name check and the unresolved customer-data flow without inventing either answer.
3. Repeat the handoff with Nell as business owner and spending and signature authority still unconfirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

A Read the situation

Translate a policy requirement into an assigned, evidenced process without confusing publication with operation.

Fictional company policy H3 requires compliance preapproval before committing to client hospitality costing more than \$100 per guest, including all charges. Other restrictions still apply at any amount. H3 was published on 1 September, but the intake check and evidence retention have no assigned operator. A proposed meal costs \$960 for eight guests, with no commitment yet made. Policy owner Mara and expense operations lead Dinesh must define who checks the request, who decides, where evidence is kept, and how exceptions are escalated. The event has not been approved.

PEOPLE / Mara: Compliance policy owner | Dinesh: Expense operations lead

PUBLISHED DOES NOT MEAN EMBEDDED IN DAILY WORK

A team may believe compliance is complete because a document has been distributed. Ask how a real request moves through the process. Distinguish the person maintaining the policy from the person operating the check and the person making the approval decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What triggers the stated H3 preapproval requirement?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A More than \$100 per guest before commitment | B Exactly \$100 or less in every case |
| C Only events costing more than \$1,000 in total | D Publication of a new policy regardless of any event |

2. What is the proposed cost per guest?

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| A \$80 | B \$120 |
| C \$100 | D \$960 |

3. What is missing from implementation?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Confirmation that the event is already approved | B An assigned check operator and evidence-retention arrangements |
| C The existence of any policy | D The proposed guest count |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

policy

An organization's stated rule or principle for decisions and behavior.

IN USE publish a policy

procedure

The defined steps for carrying out a task or requirement.

IN USE implement a procedure

control

An action or arrangement designed to address a specified risk or objective.

IN USE operate a control

control objective

The intended result of a control.

IN USE define the control objective

policy owner

The role responsible for maintaining and interpreting a policy through the authorized process.

IN USE identify the policy owner

control operator

The person performing the defined control activity.

IN USE assign the control operator

approver

A person authorized to make the relevant approval decision.

IN USE verify the approver

preventive control

A control intended to stop an unwanted event before it occurs.

IN USE design a preventive control

detective control

A control intended to identify an event or condition after or as it occurs.

IN USE operate a detective control

trigger

The condition that requires a defined action.

IN USE specify the control trigger

threshold

A boundary used by a rule or decision criterion.

IN USE apply the threshold

preapproval

Required approval before the specified action or commitment.

IN USE obtain preapproval

Precision check

The proposed meal is \$960 divided by eight, or \$120 per guest, so it exceeds the stated H3 threshold. That triggers review; it does not guarantee approval. Costs at or below \$100 are not automatically acceptable because other restrictions still apply.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

commitment

An undertaking or obligation whose relevant meaning depends on the context.

IN USE verify commitment status

control evidence

Records supporting whether and how a control was performed.

IN USE retain control evidence

evidence repository

The approved location for maintaining supporting records.

IN USE use the evidence repository

retention rule

A requirement governing how long and under what conditions records are kept.

IN USE follow retention rules

exception

A departure from a defined requirement, subject to the relevant process.

IN USE escalate an exception

override

An authorized or unauthorized bypass of a normal control, with status specified.

IN USE review control overrides

segregation of duties

Allocation of incompatible responsibilities to different roles where required.

IN USE assess segregation of duties

design effectiveness

Whether a control is suitably designed to address its objective.

IN USE assess design effectiveness

operating effectiveness

Whether a control works as intended in practice over the relevant scope.

IN USE test operating effectiveness

control frequency

How often or upon what events a control is performed.

IN USE define control frequency

implementation gap

A difference between a requirement and its practical deployment.

IN USE close the implementation gap

issue escalation

Raising an unresolved problem to the appropriate authority.

IN USE document issue escalation

Precision check

A document, a workflow design, and evidence of a completed check are different things. Publication confirms that H3 is available. Operating effectiveness requires evidence of how the relevant checks actually function, not only the existence of a policy file.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE GAP

"The policy is published, but the check has no assigned operator."

APPLY THE CORRECT BASIS

"The threshold is per guest, including all charges."

SEPARATE TRIGGER AND DECISION

"That amount requires review; it does not mean the event is approved."

ASSIGN THE ACTIVITY

"Who checks the request before a commitment is made?"

NAME THE OBJECTIVE

"The control should prevent commitments that lack required preapproval."

SHOW THE CALCULATION

"Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty."

KEEP OTHER RULES VISIBLE

"Below-threshold spending may still be subject to other restrictions."

SEPARATE THE DECISION

"Who has authority to approve or reject the request?"

Per guest

Makes the threshold basis explicit instead of substituting the total.

Requires review

Distinguishes the trigger from a favorable decision.

Before

Defines the sequence that makes this a preventive check.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SPECIFY THE EVIDENCE

"Retain the request, calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing."

CHOOSE THE REPOSITORY

"Store the records in the approved location under the applicable retention rules."

AVOID BYPASSING THE RULE

"Do not split one event to disguise the amount."

TEST THE PROCESS

"Walk a real request through the steps and verify the retained evidence."

CHECK TIMING

"The evidence must show that required approval preceded the commitment."

HANDLE ABSENCE

"Who covers the check when the usual operator is unavailable?"

ROUTE UNCERTAINTY

"Send an unclear case to the designated policy reviewer."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The design can be assigned now; actual operation still needs verification."

Who covers

Makes continuity part of the operational design.

Actual operation

Focuses on performed work rather than the existence of documentation.

Still needs verification

Prevents a design decision from becoming an unsupported effectiveness claim.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status statement is accurate?

- A** H3 is published, but the control is not yet fully assigned or evidenced.
- B** Publication proves every event has been checked.
- C** A policy owner automatically performed all past checks.
- D** The proposed meal is approved because its total is below \$1,000.

2. Which event statement matches the rule?

- A** The \$120-per-guest proposal requires preapproval before commitment.
- B** The \$960 total may be divided into smaller claims to avoid review.
- C** Eight guests make the threshold irrelevant.
- D** Approval can be assumed because no booking exists yet.

3. Which evidence is most useful?

- A** The identified request, calculation, authorized decision, and timestamps showing the sequence
- B** Only a link to the policy
- C** An undated statement that staff generally follow rules
- D** A receipt with no approval record or timing

4. What does a well-written procedure prove by itself?

- A** Every future event will comply
- B** All historical evidence exists
- C** No exception can ever occur
- D** The designed steps, not that they operated effectively in practice

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The policy is published, but the check has no owner

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

design effectiveness / control trigger / approver / threshold / Operating effectiveness / control evidence / control operator / evidence repository / issue escalation / preapproval

- 01 **Dinesh:** We uploaded H3 last month and emailed everyone. The dashboard says the policy rollout is complete. What else is missing?
- 02 **Mara:** Publication is complete, but the ¹ _____ is not assigned. For the next hospitality request, we need to know who checks the amount, who makes the decision, and where the evidence goes.
- 03 **Dinesh:** We normally check receipts after the meal. For this one, nothing is booked. Where should our check sit before somebody commits the money?
- 04 **Mara:** H3 requires ² _____ before commitment when the cost exceeds one hundred dollars per guest. An after-the-event receipt check can identify a problem, but it cannot replace that earlier requirement.
- 05 **Dinesh:** The estimate is nine hundred sixty dollars for eight guests, including all charges. Someone thought the total had to exceed a thousand.
- 06 **Mara:** The ³ _____ is per guest. Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty, so this proposal triggers compliance review. That calculation does not itself approve the event.
- 07 **Dinesh:** We can check the information on receipt, but my team should not be deciding whether the hospitality is permissible.
- 08 **Mara:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ is the designated compliance reviewer. Your team can perform the intake check and route it, while the reviewer decides under the actual policy and relevant requirements.
- 09 **Dinesh:** What should the intake check record besides the amount? I want the evidence to be useful without collecting unnecessary information.
- 10 **Mara:** The ⁵ _____ should connect the request, purpose, relevant parties, cost calculation, decision, reviewer, and timing. Use the approved fields and handling rules, and retain what the process actually requires.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Dinesh:** I found an approval in one mailbox and the estimate in another. We need to join those records before we can show what was actually approved.
- 12 **Mara:** We need an approved ⁶ _____ with the appropriate access and retention rules. A policy link does not show that a specific request was checked before commitment.
- 13 **Dinesh:** What happens if a requester says the booking cannot wait and the usual reviewer is unavailable?
- 14 **Mara:** Define the ⁷ _____ and cover arrangement. Urgency does not let the requester approve their own exception or split the event into smaller claims to make the threshold disappear.
- 15 **Dinesh:** Should every amount below one hundred dollars be marked approved automatically?
- 16 **Mara:** No. That would misread the ⁸ _____. The threshold governs this preapproval step, while other restrictions still apply at any amount. The procedure should preserve those checks rather than imply a universal permission.
- 17 **Dinesh:** Once we document these roles and test a sample request, can we say the control has always worked?
- 18 **Mara:** No. We can assess the ⁹ _____ of the defined process. A current walkthrough does not prove how earlier requests were handled or fill missing historical evidence.
- 19 **Dinesh:** Then we should separate the completed publication task from the operational work still needed, and assign the expense check explicitly.
- 20 **Mara:** Exactly. ¹⁰ _____ needs evidence from actual operation. Let us record the operator, approver, cover route, and repository, then verify that the next requests follow the intended sequence.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. control operator | 2. preapproval | 3. threshold | 4. approver | 5. control evidence | 6. evidence repository | 7. issue escalation | 8. control trigger | 9. design effectiveness | 10. Operating effectiveness

Apply another fictional preapproval rule

F Say it

Policy J2 requires review before commitment for hospitality above \$80 per guest, including all charges. A proposed event costs \$540 for six guests. Other restrictions still apply. No approval or booking is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

commitment / \$80 threshold / \$90 / not approved

Coordinator: "The proposed cost per guest is ¹ _____."

Reviewer: "That exceeds the stated ² _____."

Coordinator: "Approval is required before ³ _____."

Reviewer: "The current approval status is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. \$90 | 2. \$80 threshold | 3. commitment | 4. not approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Mara and Dinesh aloud, then swap roles. Say the \$960 total, eight guests, and \$120 per guest on the same basis.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Distinguish the intake operator from the compliance approver and approval before commitment from checking a receipt afterward.
3. Repeat the repository and cover arrangements. Keep a completed policy publication separate from evidence of the control operating.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

A Read the situation

Respond to an evidence request with the correct period, source, completeness, and limitations.

Auditor Talia requests evidence of monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March 2026. Record owner Hugo locates the January and February review packages but has not found March. A colleague suggests sending a screenshot taken on 2 April showing the current access-review setting. The screenshot does not establish whether the three monthly reviews occurred. Hugo must identify the records found, disclose the March evidence gap, and continue the authorized search. He must not backdate a new record or assert that the missing package proves the March review never happened.

PEOPLE / Talia: Compliance auditor | Hugo: Control record owner

AN EVIDENCE GAP NEEDS A PRECISE ANSWER

Audit questions can feel accusatory when teams are busy. Treat the requested period and record type as shared criteria. Acknowledge what is missing without becoming defensive, inventing evidence, or making a broader conclusion than the records support.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which period did Talia request?

A Only 2 April 2026

C An unspecified current day

B Every month after April

D January through March 2026

2. Which review packages have been found?

A None of the requested records

C All three requested months

B January and February

D Only March

3. What does the April screenshot establish by itself?

A Proof of every January-to-March review

C A replacement original March sign-off

B Proof that March was never reviewed

D The displayed current setting, not completion of all three historical reviews

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

audit scope

The subjects, boundaries, and period included in an audit.

IN USE confirm the audit scope

evidence request

A request for records supporting a specified question or assessment.

IN USE clarify the evidence request

PBC list

Prepared-by-client list; an auditor's requested information schedule in relevant practice.

IN USE maintain the PBC list

review period

The time interval covered by an assessment.

IN USE state the review period

population

The complete defined set of items relevant to a test.

IN USE establish the population

sample

Selected items examined from a defined population.

IN USE explain the sample

privileged access

Access with elevated permissions under the relevant system rules.

IN USE review privileged access

review package

The linked records supporting a particular review.

IN USE assemble the review package

source record

The originating record used as evidence.

IN USE preserve source records

provenance

Information about the origin and history of an item.

IN USE document evidence provenance

timestamp

A recorded date and time for an event.

IN USE verify timestamps

metadata

Information describing a record, such as origin, dates, and version.

IN USE retain relevant metadata

Precision check

Two located packages out of three requested months is a statement about evidence availability. It is not automatically a 66.7% control-effectiveness score. The March gap must be disclosed while the underlying activity and available alternative evidence are assessed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

contemporaneous evidence

Evidence created at or near the event it records.

IN USE locate contemporaneous evidence

retrospective account

A later description of an earlier event.

IN USE label a retrospective account

completeness

Whether all required or relevant items are included on the stated basis.

IN USE assess completeness

reliability

The extent to which information can be depended on for the intended purpose.

IN USE assess evidence reliability

relevance

The connection between evidence and the question being assessed.

IN USE assess evidence relevance

evidence gap

Missing information needed to support an assessment.

IN USE disclose an evidence gap

exception log

A record of identified departures and their handling.

IN USE reconcile the exception log

sign-off

A recorded approval or confirmation under the relevant process.

IN USE verify reviewer sign-off

reperformance

Independently carrying out a procedure to check its result.

IN USE document reperformance

redaction

Removal or obscuring of information for an authorized disclosure purpose.

IN USE document necessary redactions

audit trail

A traceable record of actions, changes, and decisions.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

management response

Management's factual reply and planned actions concerning an audit matter.

IN USE prepare the management response

Precision check

A later explanation may help an investigation, but it must be labeled with its actual creation date and source. Do not recreate a missing sign-off as if it were contemporaneous. Authorized redaction should protect information without disguising a material evidence limitation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CONFIRM THE SCOPE

"You are requesting the monthly reviews for January through March 2026."

DISCLOSE THE GAP

"We have not yet located the March package."

DESCRIBE THE SCREENSHOT

"This image was taken on the second of April and shows the current setting."

IDENTIFY THE SOURCE

"Each package will show its originating system, reviewer, and relevant dates."

STATE WHAT IS AVAILABLE

"We have located the January and February packages."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"That gap does not by itself establish whether the review occurred."

SEPARATE CONFIGURATION FROM OPERATION

"It does not demonstrate completion of the three monthly reviews."

CHECK COMPLETENESS

"Let us reconcile the requested months against the evidence index."

Have located

Reports availability, not a conclusion about every control outcome.

Not yet located

Distinguishes a search gap from proof that an event did not occur.

By itself

Restricts the inference available from one fact.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"We will retain the original files and relevant metadata."

HANDLE SENSITIVE CONTENT

"Use approved access and redaction procedures without concealing relevant gaps."

CLARIFY ALTERNATIVES

"Would these separately identified records help assess the missing period?"

AGREE A FOLLOW-UP

"I will provide the search status and any additional records by the agreed date."

AVOID BACKDATING

"Any later explanation will carry its actual creation date."

CONTINUE THE SEARCH

"We will check the authorized repositories and record the search result."

KEEP THE LIMITATION VISIBLE

"Alternative evidence must be described for what it actually proves."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The submission covers two located packages and an explicit March evidence gap."

Actual creation date

Prevents a later record from impersonating earlier evidence.

Separately identified

Keeps alternative evidence distinct from the missing original package.

Covers

Defines the scope of the submission rather than implying completeness.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which submission description is accurate?

- A** A new March sign-off can be dated earlier to complete the file.
- B** January and February packages are available; March remains an identified evidence gap.
- C** All three months are complete because the current setting is enabled.
- D** March definitely failed because the package is not yet found.

2. Which question best tests the screenshot's relevance?

- A** Does the screenshot's existence establish completeness of the quarterly submission?
- B** Does this current setting image show that the requested historical reviews actually occurred?
- C** Does the current setting prove the same setting existed throughout the quarter?
- D** Can today's enabled status stand in for each monthly reviewer sign-off?

3. How should a later employee explanation be handled?

- A** Backdate it to the month being discussed.
- B** Discard all later information without considering relevance.
- C** Label its source and actual date and assess what it supports.
- D** Treat it automatically as the missing original sign-off.

4. What does two packages out of three establish?

- A** A universal 66.7% compliance rating
- B** Proof that every user was correctly authorized
- C** Proof that March access was improper
- D** Current evidence availability for two requested months

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A current screenshot does not answer a historical question

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

source record / review packages / retrospective account / timestamp / redactions / completeness / evidence gap / management response / audit trail / review period

- 01 **Talia:** The request covers monthly privileged-access reviews for January through March. Can you confirm which records your submission will include?
- 02 **Hugo:** We have located the January and February ¹ _____. I have not found March yet, so I will identify that gap rather than describe the quarter as fully documented.
- 03 **Talia:** I also have a screenshot marked review enabled. When was it taken? I do not want to mistake a current setting for a completed monthly check.
- 04 **Hugo:** The ² _____ is the second of April. It shows the setting visible then. It does not establish that each January-to-March review was performed or signed off.
- 05 **Talia:** That distinction matters. I need evidence of operation during the requested months, not only evidence that a review feature is currently enabled.
- 06 **Hugo:** Understood. The ³ _____ remains January through March 2026. I will label the April image separately so it cannot be mistaken for a historical review record.
- 07 **Talia:** What is included in the two packages you have located? We need to understand how they connect to the control activity.
- 08 **Hugo:** Each should identify the ⁴ _____, relevant user population, reviewer, date, decision, and exceptions. I will verify those contents rather than assume a file titled completed review contains every required element.
- 09 **Talia:** Do you have an index showing the requested months and the status of each item?
- 10 **Hugo:** I am reconciling ⁵ _____ against that list. It will show two located packages and one missing package, with any further evidence added under its own source and date.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Talia:** Please be careful not to turn the missing March package into an unsupported conclusion about whether the review occurred.
- 12 **Hugo:** I will call it an ⁶ _____. It means we cannot presently support the activity with that package, not that we have established the review never happened.
- 13 **Talia:** If the reviewer remembers doing it, send that account too. Just keep its actual date visible; it cannot become the missing March sign-off.
- 14 **Hugo:** Any ⁷ _____ will have its actual creation date and author. We will not recreate a sign-off and date it in March merely to make the index look complete.
- 15 **Talia:** Some records contain user details. Follow the approved sharing process, but make clear if any removal limits what I can assess.
- 16 **Hugo:** We will document necessary ⁸ _____ and use the authorized access route. We should not conceal a relevant exception or missing field under a general statement that the package was cleaned up.
- 17 **Talia:** What will you do next to locate the missing material or determine what other evidence exists?
- 18 **Hugo:** I will check the authorized repositories and preserve the ⁹ _____ of what we find. Any alternative records will be identified separately, with an explanation of what they show and what they do not.
- 19 **Talia:** Then send the two packages, the index, and the search status by the agreed follow-up date. Keep the March limitation visible.
- 20 **Hugo:** I will make that clear in the ¹⁰ _____. The response will distinguish current configuration, the two located monthly reviews, and the outstanding March evidence question, without backdating records or inventing an effectiveness score.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. review packages | 2. timestamp | 3. review period | 4. source record | 5. completeness | 6. evidence gap | 7. retrospective account | 8. redactions | 9. audit trail | 10. management response

Describe another incomplete evidence submission

F Say it

An auditor requests April, May, and June review packages. April and May are located; June is not. A screenshot dated 3 July shows the current setting. The underlying June activity remains unverified.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

June / 3 July / nonperformance / April through June

Owner: "The requested period is ¹ _____."

Auditor: "The missing package is ² _____."

Owner: "The screenshot date is ³ _____."

Auditor: "The gap alone does not prove ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. April through June | 2. June | 3. 3 July | 4. nonperformance

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Talia and Hugo aloud, then swap roles. State the January-to-March review period before describing the April screenshot.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Explain why two located packages establish availability, not a 66.7% effectiveness score.
3. Repeat the search handoff, identifying any retrospective account by its actual author and date and preserving the March limitation.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

A Read the situation

Attribute reported events, separate inference from observation, and route sensitive concerns for impartial review.

Reporter Elena says that on 27 September she saw invoice V19 marked approved while its receiving field was blank. She interprets this as evidence that her manager took a payoff, but she did not see a payment to the manager. The records and transaction context have not been reviewed. Intake coordinator Noah must preserve the allegation and its source without recording the suspected motive as fact. Elena fears adverse shift changes if her manager learns of the report. The fictional process requires restricted handling, preservation referral, and assignment to an appropriate reviewer without a conflict.

PEOPLE / Elena: Employee making a report | Noah: Compliance intake coordinator

NEUTRAL WORDING IS NOT DISBELIEF

Attributing a statement protects the usefulness of the record; it does not mean the concern is unimportant. Explain that the review must distinguish what the reporter observed, what they inferred, and what the relevant evidence establishes. Do not demand that a reporter prove the entire case before accepting it.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Elena say she observed?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A V19 marked approved while the receiving field was blank | B A payment made directly to the manager |
| C A completed investigation finding | D A confession by the supplier |

2. What is the current status of the suspected motive?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Proof that the report must be false | B An allegation or inference that has not been established |
| C A verified fact because Elena is concerned | D A formal finding of misconduct |

3. What additional concern requires recording?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The manager has already been found guilty. | B All records may now be deleted. |
| C Elena fears adverse shift changes after reporting. | D Elena has approved the transaction. |

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

allegation

A claim that something occurred, not necessarily established as fact.

IN USE record an allegation

reported observation

An event or condition a person says they directly perceived.

IN USE attribute a reported observation

inference

A conclusion drawn from information rather than directly observed.

IN USE distinguish an inference

finding

A conclusion reached through an authorized assessment of evidence.

IN USE substantiate a finding

reporter

A person raising a concern through a relevant route.

IN USE acknowledge the reporter

subject

The person or matter being examined in an investigation.

IN USE identify the investigation subject

witness

A person who may provide relevant observations or information.

IN USE identify potential witnesses

corroboration

Additional evidence supporting an account or claim.

IN USE seek corroboration

contradictory evidence

Information that conflicts with a claim or interpretation.

IN USE assess contradictory evidence

chronology

A time-ordered account of relevant events.

IN USE establish a chronology

first-hand account

Information described by someone who directly experienced the event.

IN USE distinguish a first-hand account

hearsay

Information received from another person, with legal treatment depending on context.

IN USE attribute second-hand information

Precision check

The intake note should say Elena reports seeing an approved status and a blank receiving field. A blank field does not establish that goods were never received, that approval was improper, or that a payoff occurred. Those are separate questions for review.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

intake note

The initial record of a reported concern and its source.

IN USE prepare a neutral intake note

case handoff

Transfer of the relevant information and responsibility to the next authorized role.

IN USE document the case handoff

investigation scope

The defined questions and boundaries of an inquiry.

IN USE establish investigation scope

conflict of interest

A competing interest that may impair or appear to impair impartial judgment.

IN USE disclose a conflict of interest

independence

Freedom from inappropriate influence in the relevant assessment.

IN USE protect reviewer independence

need-to-know access

Access limited to people requiring information for an authorized purpose.

IN USE restrict access on a need-to-know basis

confidentiality

Controlled handling of information under applicable duties and limits.

IN USE explain confidentiality limits

anonymity

A person's identity being unknown or withheld in a specified context.

IN USE distinguish anonymity

retaliation concern

A concern about adverse treatment because of reporting or another protected activity.

IN USE record a retaliation concern

preservation

Keeping relevant information from being improperly lost or altered.

IN USE refer preservation needs

legal hold

A direction to preserve specified information for a legal matter under applicable requirements.

IN USE follow a legal hold

factual attribution

Identifying who said or supplied a statement and its evidential status.

IN USE maintain factual attribution

Precision check

Confidentiality is not a promise that nobody else will learn the information. Explain authorized sharing and limits accurately. Do not promise privilege, a particular result, or absolute protection; record safety or retaliation concerns and follow the relevant escalation process promptly.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REPORT

"Thank you for raising the concern; I will record what you tell me accurately."

SEPARATE INTERPRETATION

"Which part is your conclusion about what the event meant?"

AVOID A PREMATURE FINDING

"The suspected payoff has not been established."

KEEP THE CONTEXT OPEN

"We need the transaction context before concluding why the field was blank."

ASK ABOUT OBSERVATION

"What did you personally see or hear?"

ATTRIBUTE THE STATEMENT

"You report seeing V19 marked approved with a blank receiving field."

CLARIFY TIMING

"When did you see the status, and which record was it?"

RECORD UNCERTAINTY

"I will mark that detail as unknown rather than fill it in."

You report

Attaches the statement to its source without dismissing it.

Personally

Separates direct experience from information received from others.

Has not been established

Keeps the allegation open without declaring it true or false.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE RELEVANT MATERIAL

"Do not alter or delete relevant records; follow the authorized preservation instructions."

EXPLAIN HANDLING

"Information will be shared only through the authorized process with appropriate people."

CHECK IMPARTIALITY

"The reviewer must not have a conflict concerning the allegation."

AVOID PROMISING AN OUTCOME

"I cannot predict the review result or any disciplinary decision."

AVOID UNAUTHORIZED COLLECTION

"Do not access another person's account or gather material outside your permission."

AVOID ABSOLUTE SECRECY

"I cannot promise that no one else will need to know."

RECORD A SEPARATE CONCERN

"I will record your concern about possible shift changes separately."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"I will route the factual record and the additional concern to the appropriate reviewer."

Separately

Prevents a second concern from being lost inside the initial allegation.

Authorized process

Limits handling and evidence collection to appropriate roles and permissions.

Cannot predict

Avoids promising a finding or remedy before the relevant assessment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which intake sentence is neutral and useful?

- A** Elena has no concern because she cannot prove a payment.
- B** A blank receiving field establishes that no goods arrived.
- C** Elena reports seeing V19 approved with a blank receiving field and suspects a payoff.
- D** The manager took a payoff and falsified every invoice.

2. What should a reviewer do with alternative explanations?

- A** Assess relevant supporting and contradictory evidence under the authorized scope.
- B** Ignore them after the allegation is recorded.
- C** Treat them as proof the reporter lied.
- D** Ask the reporter to investigate secretly.

3. Which confidentiality statement is appropriate?

- A** Nobody else will ever see any information.
- B** Every report is automatically legally privileged.
- C** All colleagues may receive the full report to offer opinions.
- D** The report will follow restricted authorized handling, but absolute secrecy cannot be promised.

4. How should the shift concern be handled?

- A** Promise no adverse action can ever occur.
- B** Omit it because no shift change has yet happened.
- C** Ask the implicated manager alone to decide whether the report may continue.
- D** Record it as a separate concern and route it through the appropriate process.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Record the concern without turning suspicion into a finding

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

chronology / corroboration / conflict of interest / retaliation concern / preservation / reported observation / confidentiality / case handoff / inference / allegation

- 01 **Elena:** I saw V19 marked approved on the twenty-seventh of September, but the receiving field was blank. I think my manager is getting a payoff.
- 02 **Noah:** Thank you for raising it. I will separate your ¹ _____ from your interpretation. You saw the approved status and blank field. Did you personally see any payment to the manager?
- 03 **Elena:** No. The timing looked suspicious to me, but I did not see money change hands or a payment record.
- 04 **Noah:** I will record the payoff as an ² _____, not an established fact. You do not need to prove the entire concern before we receive it, but the note must be accurate about what you know.
- 05 **Elena:** I read the empty field as goods not received. That was my assumption; I did not check with receiving.
- 06 **Noah:** That is an ³ _____ we should identify. A blank field may need explanation, but it does not by itself establish nonreceipt, improper approval, or a payment to your manager.
- 07 **Elena:** A colleague may have seen the same screen. Should I ask them to agree with my account before you take it further?
- 08 **Noah:** No. Possible ⁴ _____ should be assessed through the authorized review. You can identify a potential witness, but do not coach an account or ask someone to confirm details they did not observe.
- 09 **Elena:** I remember the date clearly, although I would need to check my notes for the time. I do not want to guess.
- 10 **Noah:** Keep that distinction in the ⁵ _____. We can record the date you recall and mark the time as unconfirmed. The reviewer can assess relevant records and context rather than rely on invented precision.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Elena:** I have my own notes and a message about the invoice. I have not changed them or accessed anyone else's account.
- 12 **Noah:** I will refer the ⁶ _____ needs to the appropriate team. Keep relevant material intact and follow their instructions. Do not enter another person's account or collect information outside your permissions.
- 13 **Elena:** Can you guarantee that my manager will never learn that I contacted you? I am worried about how this could affect my work.
- 14 **Noah:** I can explain our ⁷ _____ process, but I cannot promise absolute secrecy. Information needs controlled handling by the appropriate people, and some details may need to be shared for a fair review.
- 15 **Elena:** The manager is close to someone on the usual review team. I am concerned that the report could go straight back to them.
- 16 **Noah:** We should record the possible ⁸ _____. The assignment needs an appropriate reviewer without a conflict. I will not ask the person implicated in the report to decide whether the concern may be reviewed.
- 17 **Elena:** I have not had my shifts changed yet, but I fear that could happen if the manager thinks I complained.
- 18 **Noah:** I will record that ⁹ _____ separately and route it promptly under the relevant process. Please distinguish any later event from the fear you are describing now, and use the designated contact if something changes.
- 19 **Elena:** Please read it back. I want the invoice checked; I never said I saw a payment.
- 20 **Noah:** The ¹⁰ _____ will distinguish your observation, suspected motive, unknown context, and separate concern. We cannot promise a finding or outcome.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. reported observation | 2. allegation | 3. inference | 4. corroboration | 5. chronology | 6. preservation | 7. confidentiality | 8. conflict of interest | 9. retaliation concern | 10. case handoff

Keep another allegation accurately attributed

F Say it

04

Rosa says she saw a supplier invoice marked paid before its delivery field was completed. She suspects a personal benefit to the approver but saw no such payment. The transaction context is unreviewed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

allegation / nondelivery / unreviewed / reported observation

Coordinator: "Rosa's account of the screen is a ¹ _____."

Reporter: "The suspected personal benefit is an ² _____."

Coordinator: "The blank field does not prove ³ _____."

Reporter: "The transaction context remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. reported observation | 2. allegation | 3. nondelivery | 4. unreviewed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Elena and Noah aloud, then swap roles. Attribute the invoice observation and payoff suspicion without merging them.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Reread the witness, uncertain-time, and preservation exchanges without coaching evidence or guessing details.
3. Repeat the confidentiality explanation and separate shift-change concern. Do not turn a feared event into one that has already happened.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

A Read the situation

Clarify identity and requested actions, preserve receipt details, and route timing and disclosure decisions correctly.

At 09:00 UTC on 1 October, agent Pia receives a message from an unfamiliar address signed A. Lee: Send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details. The message lacks enough information to match the person securely to an account. Privacy coordinator Wen must log the original wording and receipt time, arrange proportionate identity clarification through the approved route, and distinguish access from deletion. Applicable law, response timing, and any retention constraints need specialist confirmation. Staff must not disclose a guessed account, demand unnecessary documents, or promise automatic deletion.

PEOPLE / Pia: Customer service agent | Wen: Privacy operations coordinator

A RIGHTS REQUEST MAY ARRIVE IN ORDINARY LANGUAGE

A person may not know legal terminology or the internal team name. Recognize the substance without requiring polished English or a particular phrase. Explain why a necessary clarification protects the person, and avoid turning internal routing into a needless obstacle.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What two actions does the message request?

- A** A confirmed transfer of every account to a third party
- C** Only a password reset

- B** Access to information and deletion of contact details
- D** Only a marketing quote

2. Why is identity clarification needed here?

- A** Every request must always include a passport.
- C** Staff are entitled to postpone any inconvenient message indefinitely.

- B** Poorly phrased English invalidates all requests.
- D** The unfamiliar address and name do not securely identify the relevant account.

3. What should be preserved at intake?

- A** A rewritten deletion-only request
- C** The original wording and 1 October 09:00 UTC receipt time

- B** A guessed account number reported as confirmed
- D** Only the date a specialist eventually opens the record

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

data subject

A person to whom personal information relates in relevant data-protection frameworks.

IN USE identify the data subject

personal data

Information relating to an identified or identifiable person under applicable law.

IN USE identify personal data

SAR

Subject access request; a request to exercise the relevant right of access.

IN USE recognize a SAR

DSAR

Data subject access request; another common term for a personal-data access request.

IN USE route a DSAR

right of access

A legally defined right to obtain personal information and related information, subject to applicable rules.

IN USE assess a right-of-access request

erasure request

A request to delete personal information under the relevant rules.

IN USE assess an erasure request

rectification

Correction of inaccurate or incomplete personal information under applicable rules.

IN USE route a rectification request

identity verification

Proportionate checking that the person is who they claim to be.

IN USE complete identity verification

authorized representative

A person whose authority to act for another has been established.

IN USE verify representative authority

request scope

The information or actions covered by a request.

IN USE clarify request scope

clarification

Information sought to resolve a relevant uncertainty.

IN USE request necessary clarification

proportionality

Matching the extent of an action to its legitimate need and context.

IN USE assess proportionality

Precision check

The message contains two distinct requested actions. Recognizing an access or deletion request does not establish identity, disclosure scope, or the outcome of a deletion assessment. Preserve the original wording and avoid silently narrowing the request to make processing easier.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

data minimization

Limiting information use or collection to what is necessary for the relevant purpose.

IN USE apply data minimization

receipt timestamp

The recorded date and time the request arrived.

IN USE preserve the receipt timestamp

response deadline

The due date determined under the applicable rules and facts.

IN USE verify the response deadline

jurisdiction

The legal system or authority relevant to the matter.

IN USE confirm the applicable jurisdiction

controller

A role determining processing purposes and means under relevant data-protection law.

IN USE identify the controller role

processor

A role processing personal data on behalf of a controller under relevant law.

IN USE assess the processor role

search scope

The defined systems, records, and criteria covered by a search.

IN USE document the search scope

third-party information

Information relating to someone other than the requester.

IN USE review third-party information

exemption

A legally applicable qualification or exception requiring case-specific assessment.

IN USE assess an exemption

retention obligation

A duty to keep specified information under applicable requirements.

IN USE verify retention obligations

secure disclosure

Providing information through an appropriately protected, authorized method.

IN USE arrange secure disclosure

request log

A record of requests, actions, status, and relevant dates.

IN USE maintain the request log

Precision check

Identity checks should address the actual uncertainty without collecting unnecessary material. The applicable law and facts govern timing, any permitted pause, retention, and exemptions. Do not treat internal queue transfer or a clarification email as automatic authority to stop tracking the request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RECOGNIZE THE SUBSTANCE

"The message asks for access and deletion, even though it uses ordinary language."

KEEP THE WORDING

"Retain the original message as well as the operational summary."

AVOID DISCLOSURE BY GUESS

"Do not confirm or send a guessed account's information."

EXPLAIN THE PURPOSE

"The clarification helps us avoid disclosing your information to the wrong person."

PRESERVE RECEIPT

"Record the first of October at zero nine hundred UTC."

STATE THE UNCERTAINTY

"We cannot yet match the sender securely to an account."

ASK PROPORTIONATELY

"Use the approved route to request only the information needed to resolve identity."

SEPARATE THE ACTIONS

"Access and deletion need distinct assessment within the request."

Even though

Keeps informal wording from being mistaken for absence of a request.

Cannot yet

Identifies unresolved matching without refusing the underlying request.

Only ... needed

Limits additional collection to the relevant verification purpose.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A FALSE PROMISE

"We cannot promise that every record will be deleted automatically."

KEEP THE CLOCK VISIBLE

"Continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes a permitted change."

PROTECT OTHER PEOPLE

"Any third-party information requires the appropriate review."

USE AN APPROPRIATE DELIVERY ROUTE

"Disclosure must follow the approved secure method after the required checks."

CHECK THE GOVERNING RULES

"The privacy team needs to confirm applicable law and response timing."

CLARIFY WITHOUT COERCION

"Do not force a narrower request merely to reduce the search."

VERIFY AUTHORITY

"If a representative is acting, confirm their authority through the proper process."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Log the request, the uncertainty, the assigned owner, and the next action."

Distinct assessment

Prevents one requested action from silently replacing the other.

Unless

Keeps timing changes dependent on an authorized, applicable basis.

After the required checks

Protects disclosure without prescribing an invented universal verification method.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which initial response is appropriate?

- A** Log both requested actions and arrange necessary identity clarification through the approved route.
- B** Send the closest matching account immediately.
- C** Reject the request because it does not say DSAR.
- D** Delete all records before checking identity or retention duties.

2. Which identity approach is proportionate?

- A** Request only information needed to resolve the actual uncertainty under the approved process.
- B** Require a passport for every requester because one case needed it.
- C** Treat the nearest matching name as verified if only one account is active.
- D** Collect additional documents for possible future questions before assessing this uncertainty.

3. Which timing statement is accurate for this case?

- A** A receipt timestamp is unnecessary if identity is uncertain.
- B** The applicable rules must be confirmed; internal routing alone does not establish a paused deadline.
- C** Every clarification pauses every legal deadline worldwide.
- D** The clock begins only when the busiest team chooses to open the file.

4. What should staff avoid when clarifying scope?

- A** Recording necessary clarification
- B** Identifying an accountable request owner
- C** Silently turning the combined request into deletion only
- D** Preserving the original wording

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Recognize the request without disclosing the wrong record

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

request log / authorized representative / third-party information / jurisdiction / request scope / identity verification / response deadline / receipt timestamp / erasure request / data minimization

- 01 **Pia:** This message came in at zero nine hundred UTC on the first of October. It says send me what you hold about me and delete my contact details.
- 02 **Wen:** Record the ¹ _____ and keep the original wording. It contains an access request and a deletion request, even though the person has not used our internal terminology or a legal label.
- 03 **Pia:** The address is unfamiliar and the signature is only A. Lee. Several accounts could match that name.
- 04 **Wen:** Then ² _____ needs attention through the approved route. Do not choose the nearest account or confirm its details to this sender while the match is uncertain.
- 05 **Pia:** Our last case used a passport. Should I ask for one again, or first check what would resolve this particular account match?
- 06 **Wen:** Use ³ _____. Request only what is necessary under the approved process to resolve the uncertainty. Formal identification is not automatically the right answer in every case, and unnecessary documents create their own handling risk.
- 07 **Pia:** I can explain that we need enough information to avoid sending somebody else's record. Should I ask the person to choose access or deletion?
- 08 **Wen:** Keep both parts of the ⁴ _____. We may need necessary clarification, but we should not make them abandon one action because our queue is easier to manage that way.
- 09 **Pia:** Could we complete the access part and promise that every matching record will then be deleted?
- 10 **Wen:** No. An ⁵ _____ has its own assessment. Applicable requirements and retention constraints may affect the outcome. We should not promise deletion before the responsible team has reviewed what the request covers.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Pia:** I have seen a one-month deadline in training material. Does that automatically apply to every request our global team receives?
- 12 **Wen:** We need to confirm the applicable ⁶ _____ and rules with the privacy team. A remembered example is not a universal rule for every person, organization, or requested action.
- 13 **Pia:** The system has a pause button for clarification. Should I use it now, or does the privacy team need to confirm the timing rule first?
- 14 **Wen:** Do not assume that about the ⁷ _____. Record the action and continue tracking dates unless the authorized assessment establishes the relevant timing treatment. An internal transfer is not permission to lose the original receipt date.
- 15 **Pia:** The person may ask a family member to respond for them. How would that change the next step?
- 16 **Wen:** We would need to establish an ⁸ _____ through the proper process. A family relationship alone should not be treated as automatically proving authority to receive another person's information.
- 17 **Pia:** Once identity and scope are clear, the records may include messages involving colleagues or other customers.
- 18 **Wen:** Flag ⁹ _____ for the appropriate review. The access request does not mean we can send an unreviewed export containing everybody else's details.
- 19 **Pia:** I will log the combined request, the identity uncertainty, and the referral to the privacy team without making an outcome promise.
- 20 **Wen:** Good. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ complete with the owner and next action. Then use the approved verification, assessment, and secure-response process while preserving what the person actually requested.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. receipt timestamp | 2. identity verification | 3. data minimization | 4. request scope | 5. erasure request | 6. jurisdiction | 7. response deadline | 8. authorized representative | 9. third-party information | 10. request log

Triage another combined data request

F Say it

A message received on 7 March at 14:20 UTC asks for a copy of personal information and correction of an address. The sender cannot yet be securely matched to an account. Applicable timing rules have not been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

to be confirmed / identity clarification / 14:20 UTC / address correction

Agent: "The receipt time is ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "The second requested action is ² _____."

Agent: "Before disclosure, the account match requires ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The applicable deadline remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. 14:20 UTC | 2. address correction | 3. identity clarification | 4. to be confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Pia and Wen aloud, then swap roles. Preserve both access and deletion and the original first-of-October receipt time.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Explain the account uncertainty without demanding a passport by default or disclosing a guessed match.
3. Repeat the timing and representative-authority exchanges. Keep internal tracking separate from a confirmed legal deadline or permitted pause.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

A Read the situation

Compare vendor data flows and dependencies, identify missing evidence, and communicate unresolved risk accurately.

06

Two vendors propose workforce reporting services. Vendor A proposes department-level counts; Vendor B requests names, work email addresses, and individual salary records. B also uses separate hosting and support subcontractors, but their locations and access are unconfirmed. Business lead Paolo prefers B because its demonstration looked easier to use. Risk coordinator Imani must clarify the actual service need, data necessity, subcontractor roles, controls, and contractual arrangements. Neither vendor is approved. A smaller stated dataset does not prove A is risk-free, and a completed questionnaire alone does not prove B is suitable.

PEOPLE / Paolo: Business service owner | Imani: Third-party risk coordinator

RISK QUESTIONS SHOULD CONNECT TO THE SERVICE NEED

A business team may hear due diligence as opposition to its preferred supplier. Explain which exposure each question addresses and what evidence would help. Keep the usability benefit visible while distinguishing commercial preference from an authorized risk decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which proposed dataset is more detailed about individuals?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A's department-level counts as described | B Both are established as identical |
| C Neither contains any described information | D B's names, work emails, and salary records |

2. What is unknown about B's subcontractors?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The fact that the business saw a demonstration | B The names of every employee using the service |
| C Their locations and access | D Whether B has mentioned any subcontractors |

3. What is the current approval status?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Neither vendor is approved. | B B is approved by the demonstration. |
| C A is automatically approved because it proposes counts. | D Both are approved once a questionnaire is submitted. |

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

due diligence

Appropriate investigation before or during a relationship to understand relevant facts and risks.

IN USE conduct vendor due diligence

business rationale

The reason a service or relationship is needed.

IN USE document the business rationale

data flow

How information is collected, moved, accessed, stored, and used.

IN USE map the data flow

data necessity

Whether information is needed for the stated purpose.

IN USE assess data necessity

purpose limitation

Restricting use to the relevant permitted purposes under applicable requirements.

IN USE define purpose limitations

subcontractor

A party engaged by a supplier to perform part of the work.

IN USE identify subcontractors

subprocessor

A further processor engaged in a processing arrangement under relevant data-protection rules.

IN USE verify subprocessor roles

fourth party

A downstream provider on which a direct supplier relies.

IN USE assess fourth-party dependencies

cross-border transfer

Movement or access to information across relevant national boundaries.

IN USE assess cross-border transfers

onward disclosure

Further sharing beyond an initial recipient.

IN USE identify onward disclosures

DPA

Data processing agreement or addendum governing specified personal-data processing arrangements.

IN USE review the DPA

contractual safeguard

A contract provision intended to address a specified risk or obligation.

IN USE assess contractual safeguards

Precision check

Department-level counts may reduce some exposure relative to identified salary records, but the actual fields, group sizes, combinations, access, and use still matter. Do not label a dataset anonymous or a vendor risk-free merely because the proposal uses the word aggregate.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

security questionnaire

A structured set of questions about a supplier's security practices.

IN USE evaluate questionnaire responses

assurance report

A report providing an assessment within a defined scope, period, and method.

IN USE review assurance-report scope

audit right

A contractual or other right to examine specified records or practices.

IN USE clarify audit rights

incident notification

Communication about specified incidents under the applicable rules or agreement.

IN USE define incident-notification duties

retention period

The length of time information is kept under stated requirements.

IN USE verify retention periods

deletion verification

Evidence supporting that specified information was deleted as required.

IN USE request deletion verification

inherent risk

Risk considered before the specified controls or responses.

IN USE assess inherent risk

residual risk

Risk remaining after the assessed controls or responses.

IN USE describe residual risk

risk acceptance

An authorized decision to take a defined risk under the relevant framework.

IN USE document risk acceptance

remediation

Work to correct an identified weakness or issue.

IN USE track remediation

ongoing monitoring

Continuing review of relevant changes and performance after initial assessment.

IN USE plan ongoing monitoring

exit plan

Arrangements for ending the relationship and handling dependencies and data.

IN USE assess the exit plan

Precision check

A questionnaire is one information source, not an approval. Assess the relevant evidence, scope, period, exceptions, and actual service arrangement. Downstream access and locations can affect the assessment; an unconfirmed detail should remain an explicit gap rather than become an assumed safeguard.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE BENEFIT

"The demonstration suggests B may be easier for the team to use."

COMPARE THE INPUTS

"A proposes department counts; B requests person-level salary and contact data."

MAP THE FLOW

"Where is each field stored, accessed, and sent?"

KEEP LOCATIONS OPEN

"Their access locations are not yet confirmed."

CLARIFY THE PURPOSE

"Which decisions does the reporting service need to support?"

CHALLENGE NECESSITY

"Which of those individual fields are needed for the agreed purpose?"

IDENTIFY DOWNSTREAM ROLES

"What do the hosting and support subcontractors actually do?"

AVOID A LABEL SHORTCUT

"Calling the data aggregate does not by itself establish anonymity."

06

Suggests

Recognizes the demonstration without treating it as complete production evidence.

Which fields

Links collection to the actual reporting purpose.

Not yet confirmed

Keeps an unknown location or access right visible.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASSESS EVIDENCE

"The questionnaire is a starting point, not a completed approval."

CLARIFY SAFEGUARDS

"We need the relevant processing, access, retention, and notification arrangements."

SEPARATE RISK STATES

"Assess the initial exposure and the risk remaining after verified controls."

MONITOR CHANGE

"Material changes to data use or subcontractors need the agreed review."

CHECK SCOPE

"Does the assurance evidence cover the proposed service and current period?"

CHECK THE END OF THE RELATIONSHIP

"What happens to the data and dependencies when the service ends?"

NAME THE DECISION AUTHORITY

"Any risk acceptance belongs to the designated authorized role."

CLOSE THE RECOMMENDATION

"Record the business benefit, evidence, unresolved gaps, and approval status together."

06

By itself

Avoids assigning a legal or risk conclusion from one label.

Verified controls

Distinguishes claimed safeguards from assessed evidence.

Together

Prevents a favorable commercial summary from omitting unresolved risk.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is justified?

- A** B is unsuitable solely because it has any subcontractor.
- B** A and B are identical because their demonstrations have similar charts.
- C** B proposes more person-level data and unresolved downstream access, requiring relevant assessment.
- D** A has zero risk because it uses the word counts.

2. What is a useful question about salary fields?

- A** Can they be collected simply because the vendor requested them?
- B** Does a colorful dashboard eliminate the need to know?
- C** Can the business hide the fields from the risk team?
- D** Are they necessary for the agreed reporting purpose, and who would access them?

3. How should a questionnaire be treated?

- A** As permission to ignore subcontractor access
- B** As proof every answer has been independently tested
- C** As one source to evaluate alongside relevant supporting evidence and gaps
- D** As a universal certificate of legal compliance

4. Who may accept an identified residual risk?

- A** The vendor's salesperson on the customer's behalf
- B** The intake system automatically after an upload
- C** The designated authorized decision-maker under the actual framework
- D** Anyone who liked the demonstration

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Similar services do not necessarily create similar exposure

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

contractual safeguards / ongoing monitoring / data necessity / cross-border transfers / business rationale / subcontractor / risk acceptance / inherent risk / data flow / security questionnaire

- 01 **Paolo:** B's demonstration was easier to use. Both vendors produce workforce reports, so I hoped the risk review could be the same for each.
- 02 **Imani:** Let us preserve that usability benefit while checking the ¹ _____. Which decisions do the reports need to support, and what information is actually necessary to make them?
- 03 **Paolo:** We need department-level planning. A proposes counts by department, while B asks for employee names, work emails, and individual salaries.
- 04 **Imani:** That makes ² _____ an important question. We should ask why each person-level field is needed instead of assuming a more detailed input always produces a more suitable service.
- 05 **Paolo:** I just found two other companies in B's diagram: hosting and support. The arrows do not show whether support staff can read the salary records.
- 06 **Imani:** We need the ³ _____ and access roles. A diagram should show where the information is stored, who can reach it, and what each downstream provider does with it.
- 07 **Paolo:** The sales team called them standard subcontractors. Does that description settle the question?
- 08 **Imani:** No. We need to identify each ⁴ _____ and its actual role. Whether a particular party is a subprocessor under the relevant arrangement needs assessment, not an assumption from a sales label.
- 09 **Paolo:** We have not been told where the hosting and support activities occur. Should I put our own country in the form for now?
- 10 **Imani:** Leave the location unconfirmed and flag possible ⁵ _____ for the appropriate review. An assumed location can distort both the risk assessment and the contractual questions that follow.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Paolo:** A's proposal is simpler. Can we mark it low risk without asking anything further because it only mentions department counts?
- 12 **Imani:** Not automatically. Its ⁶ _____ depends on the actual fields, group sizes, combinations, access, and use. Counts can reduce some exposure, but the label aggregate does not establish anonymity or remove every service risk.
- 13 **Paolo:** B returned the questionnaire this morning. Purchasing is asking whether completed means cleared. What should I tell them is still outstanding?
- 14 **Imani:** The ⁷ _____ is one source of information. We still need relevant evidence, its scope and date, any exceptions, and the actual arrangements for this service.
- 15 **Paolo:** What should the agreement and operational plan cover beyond the questionnaire answers?
- 16 **Imani:** The appropriate ⁸ _____ and operating arrangements need review: permitted use, access, downstream providers, retention, incident communication, and what happens at exit. A document title alone does not settle those questions.
- 17 **Paolo:** If some uncertainty remains after those checks, can the business record it and decide whether to proceed?
- 18 **Imani:** Any ⁹ _____ must follow the actual authority framework. The decision-maker needs the remaining exposure and evidence gaps, not a summary that hides them behind a favorable demonstration.
- 19 **Paolo:** I will request the data-flow details and field rationale, and keep both vendors unapproved until the relevant decision is made.
- 20 **Imani:** Good. Include ¹⁰ _____ in the proposal as well. Data use and subcontractors can change after onboarding, so the relationship needs a defined review process rather than a one-time green label.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. business rationale | 2. data necessity | 3. data flow | 4. subcontractor | 5. cross-border transfers | 6. inherent risk | 7. security questionnaire | 8. contractual safeguards | 9. risk acceptance | 10. ongoing monitoring

Compare another pair of proposed services

F Say it

Vendor C proposes site-level totals. Vendor D requests named staff records and uses an external support provider whose access is unknown. Neither is approved, and the business purpose needs clarification.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

business purpose / approved / zero risk / access

Coordinator: "The unresolved support issue is ¹ _____."

Owner: "We must clarify the service's ² _____."

Coordinator: "Neither supplier is currently ³ _____."

Owner: "A site-level-total label does not prove ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. access | 2. business purpose | 3. approved | 4. zero risk

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Paolo and Imani aloud, then swap roles. Compare department counts with named salary records without assuming either supplier is approved.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Ask about each downstream provider, its access, and location while leaving unknown details unconfirmed.
3. Repeat the recommendation with the usability benefit, evidence gaps, decision authority, and continuing review arrangements all visible.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Completion is not the same as understanding

A Read the situation

Report completion separately from understanding and explain a policy through precise, role-relevant examples.

The learning system shows 490 completions among 500 assigned employees, or 98%. Separately, 20 volunteers answer an application question; only eight answer correctly. Fictional policy W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekend work. Disclosure is not automatic prohibition, and the review outcome depends on the actual policy process. Employees still ask whether weekend assignments count. Training coordinator Sofia and compliance adviser Ren must report the two measures accurately and improve the explanation. The volunteer group is not established as representative of all 500 employees.

PEOPLE / Sofia: Compliance training coordinator | Ren: Compliance adviser

07

QUESTIONS CAN INDICATE ENGAGEMENT, NOT DEFIANCE

People may stay silent if asking for clarification is treated as failure. Welcome questions about a concrete rule and provide accessible explanations. Keep completion reporting honest while testing whether employees can apply the policy in the situations their roles actually encounter.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the 98% figure measure?

A Proof that nobody needs further explanation

B Recorded course completion among 500 assigned employees

C Verified compliant behavior by 98% of all employees

D Correct answers by 98% of the volunteer group

2. How many volunteers answered correctly?

A Four hundred ninety of five hundred

B Twenty of twenty

C Eight of twenty

D Twelve of twenty

3. What does W4 require for paid weekend work?

A Disclosure before it begins

B Automatic prohibition in every case

C Disclosure only after payment arrives

D No disclosure because it occurs on a weekend

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

LMS

Learning management system; a platform for assigning, delivering, and recording training.

IN USE review LMS records

completion rate

The share of an assigned population meeting a defined completion condition.

IN USE calculate the completion rate

assigned cohort

The defined group required to complete a learning activity.

IN USE verify the assigned cohort

completion criterion

The condition used to mark an activity complete.

IN USE define completion criteria

attestation

A recorded statement confirming specified facts or understanding, with its meaning defined.

IN USE obtain an attestation

acknowledgment

Confirmation of receipt or awareness under the stated process.

IN USE record policy acknowledgment

knowledge check

An assessment of particular knowledge at a stated point.

IN USE administer a knowledge check

application question

A question testing use of a rule in a concrete situation.

IN USE design an application question

scenario-based assessment

An assessment using realistic situations to test defined decisions.

IN USE use scenario-based assessment

learning objective

A specific capability the instruction aims to develop.

IN USE define learning objectives

role-based training

Instruction tailored to the tasks and risks of particular roles.

IN USE deliver role-based training

job aid

A concise reference supporting a task at the point of work.

IN USE provide a job aid

Precision check

Completion is 490 divided by 500, or 98%, leaving 10 without recorded completion. The volunteer application result is eight divided by 20, or 40%. Different populations and measures prevent either percentage from replacing the other.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

plain language

Wording that the intended audience can understand and use.

IN USE explain in plain language

localization

Adaptation of material for a particular language, setting, or audience.

IN USE review localization

accessibility

The ability of people with varied needs to access and use the material.

IN USE check training accessibility

advice channel

A defined route for obtaining guidance on a question.

IN USE identify the advice channel

speak-up culture

A work environment that supports raising questions and concerns.

IN USE support a speak-up culture

knowledge gap

Missing or inaccurate understanding of specified information.

IN USE identify knowledge gaps

application gap

Difficulty applying a known rule to a real situation.

IN USE address application gaps

volunteer sample

A group whose members choose to participate.

IN USE qualify a volunteer sample

representativeness

How well a group reflects the population relevant to a conclusion.

IN USE assess representativeness

remedial learning

Targeted instruction addressing an identified learning need.

IN USE provide remedial learning

follow-up assessment

A later check of a specified learning outcome.

IN USE conduct a follow-up assessment

behavior measure

An indicator of what people actually do, distinct from attendance or reported knowledge.

IN USE define behavior measures

Precision check

W4 requires prior disclosure of outside paid work, including weekends. That does not mean every disclosed activity is prohibited. A training acknowledgment, a correct answer, and actual workplace behavior are different forms of evidence; each claim needs its own basis.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE MEASURE

"Ninety-eight percent refers to recorded training completion."

KEEP THE REMAINDER VISIBLE

"Ten assigned employees lack recorded completion."

QUALIFY THE SAMPLE

"We have not established that the volunteers represent the whole workforce."

STATE THE RULE PLAINLY

"Under W4, disclose outside paid work before it begins."

STATE THE DENOMINATOR

"Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed it."

REPORT THE SEPARATE CHECK

"Eight of twenty volunteers answered the application question correctly."

AVOID THE OVERCLAIM

"We cannot report ninety-eight percent compliant behavior from this measure."

ADDRESS THE EXAMPLE

"Weekend work is included in that disclosure requirement."

Refers to

Defines the claim instead of letting a percentage imply broader success.

Lack recorded completion

Describes the system evidence without assuming a reason for the missing record.

Have not established

Makes the sample limitation explicit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE DISCLOSURE AND OUTCOME

"Disclosure does not automatically mean the work is prohibited."

WELCOME THE QUESTION

"Asking how the rule applies is a useful part of learning."

MAKE HELP AVAILABLE

"Give employees a clear advice channel for uncertain cases."

TEST THE SPECIFIC OBJECTIVE

"Use a follow-up scenario to check whether the timing rule is understood."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT ROUTE

"The designated reviewer applies the actual policy process."

FOCUS THE INSTRUCTION

"Let us practice the distinction between disclosure timing and approval outcome."

CHECK ACCESSIBILITY

"Confirm that the wording and format are usable for the intended audience."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Report completion, the limited application result, and the targeted follow-up separately."

Before it begins

Places the required disclosure ahead of the activity.

Does not automatically

Separates a procedural requirement from its possible outcomes.

Separately

Prevents completion and effectiveness measures from being merged into a misleading headline.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which headline is supported?

- A** Every non-completer has deliberately refused training.
- B** Training completion is 98%; a separate volunteer check identified an application gap.
- C** Ninety-eight percent of employees behave compliantly in every situation.
- D** Forty percent of all employees understand every policy.

2. An employee plans paid weekend work. What does W4 require?

- A** Automatic resignation from the outside role
- B** Disclosure before the work begins
- C** Waiting until the first payment arrives
- D** No action because weekends are outside normal hours

3. What should be said about the 40% application result?

- A** It is the verified understanding rate of all five hundred employees.
- B** It replaces the completion denominator.
- C** It proves the training caused misconduct.
- D** It describes eight correct answers among twenty volunteers, with representativeness unestablished.

4. Which follow-up is most relevant?

- A** A demand that employees stop asking questions
- B** Reclassification of every volunteer as non-compliant
- C** A clear W4 example, an advice route, and a later check of the same disclosure-timing distinction
- D** Another completion reminder with no explanation of the misunderstood rule

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Completion is not the same as understanding

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

assigned cohort / advice channel / follow-up assessment / completion rate / application gap / acknowledgment / job aid / role-based training / volunteer sample / accessibility

07

- 01 **Sofia:** The learning dashboard shows ninety-eight percent completion. Our summary currently says the workforce is ninety-eight percent compliant.
- 02 **Ren:** That overstates the ¹ _____. Four hundred ninety of five hundred assigned employees completed the course. It does not measure every person's understanding or behavior in the situations covered by the policy.
- 03 **Sofia:** Ten people do not have a completion record. I will check the assignments and any approved exceptions rather than assume they refused.
- 04 **Ren:** Good. Keep the ² _____ and completion criteria clear. We should know who was assigned and what the system counts as complete before drawing conclusions from the percentage.
- 05 **Sofia:** The application check tells a different story: eight correct answers from twenty volunteers. I cannot use the five-hundred-person denominator for that result.
- 06 **Ren:** That is forty percent in the ³ _____. It identifies a concern worth addressing, but it does not establish that forty percent of the whole workforce understands the policy or that everyone else has failed.
- 07 **Sofia:** Most questions were about paid weekend assignments. People thought the disclosure rule only concerned work during their normal hours.
- 08 **Ren:** Then the ⁴ _____ is specific. W4 requires disclosure of outside paid work before it begins, including weekends. We can explain that plainly without adding a rule that all outside work is prohibited.
- 09 **Sofia:** The course includes an acknowledgment at the end. Could we use that as evidence that everyone accepted the exact meaning of every example?
- 10 **Ren:** An ⁵ _____ means what its wording and process establish. It is not automatic evidence of correct application in every situation, especially when the follow-up questions show a particular misunderstanding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Sofia:** Someone showed me the policy on their phone. They could not find the weekend example. Could we put the trigger and advice contact in a short reminder?
- 12 **Ren:** A ⁶ _____ can state the trigger, timing, and advice route. It should point to the current policy and avoid simplifying disclosure required into activity forbidden.
- 13 **Sofia:** Some roles rarely face this issue, while others receive outside-work offers regularly. We should not assume one long module fits them equally.
- 14 **Ren:** Use ⁷ _____ with relevant examples. Keep the rule consistent, but make the situations recognizable to the employees who need to apply it.
- 15 **Sofia:** A few employees hesitate to ask because they think a question will be treated as evidence that they did something wrong.
- 16 **Ren:** We need a credible ⁸ _____. Asking before acting can help the policy work. We should not train people to hide uncertainty merely to preserve a clean-looking dashboard.
- 17 **Sofia:** I will review the wording and format as well. Some of the examples rely on expressions that are hard for multilingual teams to interpret.
- 18 **Ren:** Check ⁹ _____ and localization with the intended audience. Completion in the system does not prove that the language or format made the requirement easy to understand.
- 19 **Sofia:** After the revised example, we can ask another fixed scenario about when disclosure is needed and what disclosure does not automatically mean.
- 20 **Ren:** That ¹⁰ _____ matches the objective. Report completion, the limited application result, and the targeted next check separately, then assess whether the actual misunderstanding has been reduced.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. completion rate | 2. assigned cohort | 3. volunteer sample | 4. application gap | 5. acknowledgment | 6. job aid | 7. role-based training | 8. advice channel | 9. accessibility | 10. follow-up assessment

Report another training result precisely

F Say it

A course has 285 completions among 300 assigned employees. A separate group of 30 volunteers answers one application question; 18 answer correctly. The group is not established as representative.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

60% / 95% / representativeness / fifteen

Coordinator: "The completion rate is ¹ _____."

Adviser: "The number without recorded completion is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The volunteer correct-answer rate is ³ _____."

Adviser: "Generalizing that result requires assessing ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. 95% | 2. fifteen | 3. 60% | 4. representativeness

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Sofia and Ren aloud, then swap roles. Say 490 of 500 and eight of twenty before giving their separate percentages.
2. Correct the ten gaps. State that paid weekend work requires disclosure before starting, not automatic rejection.
3. Repeat the targeted follow-up and advice route. Keep a volunteer result distinct from workforce understanding or observed behavior.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An approved plan is not a closed action

A Read the situation

Report action status, remaining exposure, and requested decisions against explicit closure criteria.

On 1 October, committee action G12 appears as complete because its remediation plan was approved on 12 September. Its due date was 30 September. The fictional closure rule requires implementation evidence and independent verification; neither is available. Action owner Owen has requested 15 October as a new due date, but no extension is approved. Risk coordinator Sara must correct the status for the 7 October committee meeting, preserve the history, and identify the decision needed. Approval of a revised date would not itself prove implementation or accept all remaining risk.

PEOPLE / Owen: Remediation action owner | Sara: Risk committee coordinator

ACCURATE BAD NEWS IS USABLE MANAGEMENT INFORMATION

An overdue action can be uncomfortable to report, especially after a visible milestone has been achieved. Credit the approved plan while keeping the unfinished evidence visible. A clear status enables a real decision; a reassuring label can hide the very issue the committee needs to address.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why was G12 marked complete?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The due date was removed from the record. | B The plan was approved on 12 September. |
| C Implementation and independent verification were both completed. | D The committee approved an extension to 15 October. |

2. What evidence is needed for closure under the stated rule?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Only the action owner's preferred status label | B Implementation evidence and independent verification |
| C Only a newly proposed date | D Only the approved plan |

3. What is the status of 15 October?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A The original deadline | B An already approved extension |
| C The date independent verification was completed | D Requested but not approved |

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

governance

The structures and processes for direction, oversight, and accountability.

IN USE support effective governance

committee charter

A document defining a committee's purpose, scope, and authority.

IN USE review the committee charter

terms of reference

The agreed purpose, responsibilities, and operating boundaries of a body or task.

IN USE confirm terms of reference

quorum

The participation requirement for a body to conduct specified business under its rules.

IN USE verify quorum

decision rights

The allocation of authority to make particular decisions.

IN USE clarify decision rights

delegated authority

Decision power assigned within specified limits.

IN USE verify delegated authority

action owner

The person responsible for delivering a defined action.

IN USE identify the action owner

risk owner

The person accountable for managing a specified risk under the framework.

IN USE identify the risk owner

closure criterion

A condition required to mark an action closed.

IN USE apply closure criteria

implementation evidence

Records showing that the planned change has actually been put into effect.

IN USE verify implementation evidence

independent verification

Assessment by an appropriately separate reviewer under the relevant requirements.

IN USE obtain independent verification

residual exposure

The risk remaining after the relevant measures are assessed.

IN USE describe residual exposure

08

Precision check

As of 1 October, the 30 September due date has passed and no approved extension exists. G12 therefore remains open and overdue under the supplied facts. The 15 October request must remain labeled proposed until the authorized process decides it.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

proposed extension

A requested change to timing that has not yet been approved.

IN USE record a proposed extension

approved extension

A timing change authorized through the relevant process.

IN USE document an approved extension

overdue action

An action whose applicable due date has passed without completion.

IN USE report overdue actions

status date

The date as of which a status report is accurate.

IN USE state the status date

risk appetite

The broad amount or type of risk an organization is willing to take under its framework.

IN USE define risk appetite

risk tolerance

Specified acceptable boundaries around relevant risk or performance measures.

IN USE monitor risk tolerance

KRI

Key risk indicator; a defined measure used to monitor risk conditions.

IN USE interpret a KRI

risk register

A record of identified risks, ownership, assessment, and responses.

IN USE maintain the risk register

mitigation plan

Proposed actions intended to reduce a specified risk.

IN USE approve a mitigation plan

decision log

A record of decisions, authority, reasons, and relevant conditions.

IN USE maintain the decision log

exception reporting

Reporting departures from stated criteria or expectations.

IN USE provide exception reporting

escalation threshold

A defined condition requiring referral to a higher or different authority.

IN USE apply escalation thresholds

08

Precision check

Approving a plan, changing a date, verifying implementation, and accepting risk are separate decisions. Do not report a percentage complete without a defined measurement basis. A later approved extension should preserve the original due date and decision history rather than erase the earlier status.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE REPORTING DATE

"This status is as of the first of October."

KEEP CLOSURE SEPARATE

"Plan approval does not satisfy the closure criteria."

CORRECT THE LABEL

"The action remains open and overdue against the thirtieth of September deadline."

PRESERVE HISTORY

"Keep the original deadline and the reason for each status change."

CREDIT THE COMPLETED MILESTONE

"The remediation plan was approved on the twelfth of September."

NAME THE MISSING EVIDENCE

"Implementation evidence and independent verification are outstanding."

QUALIFY THE NEW DATE

"The fifteenth of October is requested, not approved."

ASK FOR THE ACTUAL DECISION

"The committee needs to consider the extension request through its authority process."

08

As of

Fixes the date to which the status applies.

Outstanding

Identifies unfinished evidence without pretending a plan is implementation.

Against

States which deadline is used to judge lateness.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE AUTHORITY

"A date change does not automatically accept the remaining risk."

IDENTIFY OWNERSHIP

"Owen owns delivery of the action; the risk owner addresses the remaining exposure."

DEFINE VERIFICATION

"The independent reviewer must assess the required implementation evidence."

ESCALATE APPROPRIATELY

"Use the actual escalation threshold and committee mandate."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED SCORE

"We have no defined basis for calling the action ninety percent complete."

STATE THE IMPACT

"Explain what remains exposed while the action is unverified."

RECORD CONDITIONS

"Any decision should identify its scope, owner, conditions, and date."

CLOSE THE REPORT

"Show the achieved milestone, missing evidence, current deadline, and requested decision together."

08

Requested, not approved

Distinguishes a proposal from an authorized timing change.

Does not automatically

Prevents one decision from silently conferring broader authority.

Together

Keeps progress and unresolved exposure visible in the same report.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which 1 October status is accurate?

- A** Open and overdue; plan approved, implementation and verification evidence outstanding.
- B** Complete because the plan was approved.
- C** On time because 15 October has been requested.
- D** Independently verified because the owner attended the meeting.

2. What would an approved extension establish by itself?

- A** Completed implementation
- B** Automatic acceptance of every legal or operational risk
- C** Independent verification of the control
- D** An authorized timing change under its stated conditions

3. Which record should be retained if timing changes?

- A** An earlier approval date invented to remove lateness
- B** A complete label without supporting evidence
- C** The original deadline, extension decision, authority, reason, and new conditions
- D** Only the newest date with all prior entries deleted

4. What should the committee paper request?

- A** Closure solely to improve the overdue count
- B** The specific extension decision and any separate action needed for remaining exposure
- C** Approval of an undefined statement that everything is fine
- D** Retroactive proof that evidence was already supplied

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

An approved plan is not a closed action

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

exception reporting / status date / independent verification / proposed extension / action owner / residual exposure / decision rights / Implementation evidence / closure criteria / decision log

08

- 01 **Owen:** G12 is marked complete in the tracker. The plan was approved on the twelfth of September, so I assumed we could close the action.
- 02 **Sara:** The ¹ _____ require implementation evidence and independent verification. Neither is available yet. We can record the approved plan as a completed milestone without treating the whole action as closed.
- 03 **Owen:** The original date was the thirtieth of September. I requested the fifteenth of October because the implementation work is taking longer.
- 04 **Sara:** That is a ² _____, not an approved one. As of the first of October, the applicable deadline is still the thirtieth of September, so the action is open and overdue.
- 05 **Owen:** The plan took weeks to agree. If the paper just says overdue, that work disappears. Can we show the milestone without calling the action closed?
- 06 **Sara:** The ³ _____ lets us be precise. We will show the achieved milestone and the outstanding evidence together. Accurate overdue reporting does not erase the work already completed.
- 07 **Owen:** Can I describe it as ninety percent complete? That might communicate that the plan is nearly ready to deliver.
- 08 **Sara:** Not without a defined basis. ⁴ _____ needs to show the actual change required by the action. A persuasive percentage is not a substitute for the records the closure rule specifies.
- 09 **Owen:** I can provide the deployment records when they are ready. Who then decides whether they meet the requirement?
- 10 **Sara:** The designated reviewer performs ⁵ _____. We need that assessment recorded, including any exceptions, rather than assume your submission automatically proves the action can be closed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Owen:** For the seventh of October meeting, I want the committee to approve the revised date. What else should the paper make clear?
- 12 **Sara:** It should explain the remaining ⁶ _____ and the effect of delay. The risk owner needs that information, alongside your delivery plan, rather than only a request to make the overdue label disappear.
- 13 **Owen:** If the committee agrees to the new date, would that count as accepting the remaining risk until then?
- 14 **Sara:** We must check the ⁷ _____. A timing extension and risk acceptance are different decisions. The committee's mandate and any delegated authority determine what it can actually decide.
- 15 **Owen:** I will keep myself listed as the delivery owner, but the business risk owner should speak to the consequences and any interim measures.
- 16 **Sara:** Correct. The ⁸ _____ and risk owner can have different responsibilities. Naming one person on the tracker does not automatically transfer every decision or accountability to them.
- 17 **Owen:** The tracker shows only one due-date field. If the extension is approved, where do we keep the original deadline and the committee's conditions?
- 18 **Sara:** Update the current field while preserving the ⁹ _____. Retain the original deadline, the request, and any authorized decision with its reasons and conditions. Do not rewrite the history to imply the action was never overdue.
- 19 **Owen:** Then the paper will show plan approved, evidence outstanding, overdue as of the first, and the requested fifteenth-of-October extension.
- 20 **Sara:** Yes. That is useful ¹⁰ _____. The committee can assess the actual request and remaining exposure, and we can close G12 only when the required evidence and verification support closure.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. closure criteria | 2. proposed extension | 3. status date | 4. Implementation evidence | 5. independent verification | 6. residual exposure | 7. decision rights | 8. action owner | 9. decision log | 10. exception reporting

Report another action against its closure rule

F Say it

Action K09 was due on 10 June. As of 12 June, its plan is approved but required implementation evidence and independent verification are missing. A 25 June extension has been requested but not approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

08

WORD + PHRASE BANK

proposed extension / independent verification / 12 June / open and overdue

Coordinator: "The status date is ¹ _____."

Owner: "The current action status is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The twenty-fifth of June is a ³ _____."

Owner: "Closure also requires ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. 12 June | 2. open and overdue | 3. proposed extension | 4. independent verification

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read Owen and Sara aloud, then swap roles. Give the first-of-October status against the thirtieth-of-September deadline.
2. Correct the ten gaps. Separate plan approval, implementation evidence, independent verification, and the proposed extension.
3. Repeat the committee request, keeping the original date and any authorized decision in the history. Do not imply that a date change accepts risk.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Review the bill line by line

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Challenge a billing discrepancy precisely while separating proposed adjustments from payment authorization.

Fictional engagement: associate \$300/hour, partner \$500/hour. Invoice: associate 12 hours at \$325; partner four hours at \$500, including a disputed one-hour duplicate; \$150 allowed expense. No tax or discount. Counsel confirms the duplicate should be removed. Legal operations checks the correction; the matter owner approves payment.

PEOPLE / Amal: Legal operations analyst | Theo: Law firm billing coordinator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

matter owner / engagement terms / revised invoice / block billing / duplicate entry / rate adjustment

- 01 **Amal:** I have two queries on the matter's invoice: the associate rate and a partner entry that appears twice. Can we reconcile them before the matter owner approves payment?
- 02 **Theo:** Certainly. Let us use the ¹ _____ as the starting point. The associate rate is three hundred per hour, although this invoice used three hundred twenty-five.
- 03 **Amal:** Twelve hours at the billed rate gives three thousand nine hundred. At the agreed rate, the same twelve hours comes to three thousand six hundred.
- 04 **Theo:** That creates a ² _____ of three hundred dollars. I will correct the rate, not reduce the recorded hours to force the same total.
- 05 **Amal:** The partner line totals two thousand for four hours. One hour appears duplicated, but I do not want to delete a genuine separate task on appearance alone.
- 06 **Theo:** Counsel has checked the underlying entries and confirmed a ³ _____. Removing that one hour leaves three hours at five hundred, or fifteen hundred.
- 07 **Amal:** So the two corrections are separate: three hundred for the associate rate and five hundred for the duplicate. The allowed expense is still one hundred fifty.
- 08 **Theo:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ should total five thousand two hundred fifty. That is eight hundred less than the original six thousand fifty, without changing the allowed expense.
- 09 **Amal:** Please retain the original invoice number and identify how the replacement relates to it. Accounts payable must not treat both versions as separate bills to pay.
- 10 **Theo:** I will follow our correction process and reference the superseded version. The corrected lines will show what changed; we will not simply send an unexplained lower total.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Amal:** One description combines a call, document review, and drafting into a single time entry. Our billing guidelines require separate tasks. Can counsel supply the actual breakdown?
- 12 **Theo:** I will query that ⁵ _____. We should obtain the recorded detail, not invent equal fractions for each task because the total happens to reconcile.
- 13 **Amal:** That clarification may affect review status. The arithmetic correction alone does not prove that every service description meets the client's billing requirements.
- 14 **Theo:** Understood. We will keep the narrative query open and distinguish the corrected amount from a fully cleared invoice. Any further adjustment needs its own supported basis.
- 15 **Amal:** For the reporting dashboard, I will label the eight hundred as a proposed invoice reduction until the corrected bill is accepted. It is not money already recovered.
- 16 **Theo:** And the ⁶ _____ still needs to approve payment. Your review documents the discrepancies and reconciliation, rather than replacing that approval.
- 17 **Amal:** Exactly. I will send the rate comparison, confirmed duplicate, expense support, and outstanding narrative question together so the reviewer sees the whole position.
- 18 **Theo:** I will return the linked corrected invoice and response through the agreed billing channel. We can then reconcile the payable record without losing the original history.
- 19 **Amal:** Our read-back is five thousand two hundred fifty on the stated corrections, with the task breakdown still being clarified and payment approval outstanding.
- 20 **Theo:** Agreed. I will not mark it paid or fully approved merely because the corrected arithmetic now matches the engagement rates.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. engagement terms | 2. rate adjustment | 3. duplicate entry | 4. revised invoice | 5. block billing | 6. matter owner

Separate rate and duplicate corrections

F Say it in a new situation

Agreed rate \$200/hour. An invoice bills ten hours at \$220, including two confirmed duplicate hours, plus an allowed \$100 expense. No tax or discount. Correct the rate on all ten hours first, then remove duplicates at the agreed rate. Payment approval is outstanding.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval / 400 / 200 / 1700

09

Analyst: The rate correction alone reduces the bill by \$¹ _____.

Coordinator: Removing the two duplicates at the agreed rate reduces it by another \$² _____.

Analyst: Eight valid hours plus the expense produce a corrected total of \$³ _____.

Coordinator: Correct arithmetic does not establish payment ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 200 | 2. 400 | 3. 1700 | 4. approval

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Preserve before deletion

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Coordinate a scoped legal hold across people and systems without confusing acknowledgment, preservation, and disclosure.

Fictional hold H27: preserve named custodians' relevant Project Cedar email, chat, and shared files from 1 March onward, including new material. Chat deletion is tonight; one custodian leaves tomorrow. Counsel owns scope and release; IT implements and verifies protection. Some acknowledgments are missing.

PEOPLE / Leah: Legal operations coordinator | Sam: IT records administrator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

custodian list / scope / preservation / hold release / acknowledgment / deletion suspension

10

- 01 **Leah:** Counsel issued H27 this morning. Project Cedar chat is due for routine deletion tonight, and one named employee leaves tomorrow. Which preservation steps are actually in place?
- 02 **Sam:** The email hold is active, but chat and shared files are still being configured. I will not mark ¹ _____ complete across all three sources just because the first system is covered.
- 03 **Leah:** The notice covers relevant material from March first onward, including new records. It is not a snapshot ending today.
- 04 **Sam:** I need to confirm the ² _____ against actual accounts and locations. The departing employee's chat identity differs from the email username, so that mapping needs attention.
- 05 **Leah:** Please contact the responsible administrators now. Confirm scoped protection before tonight's deletion and tomorrow's departure processes run.
- 06 **Sam:** I will coordinate the necessary ³ _____ and verify its effect. I will report any source we cannot protect in time to counsel promptly, not leave an unanswered ticket overnight.
- 07 **Leah:** The departure workflow normally removes access and later deletes the account. We still need to protect records without leaving the employee authorized to use company systems.
- 08 **Sam:** Those are separate settings. We can arrange authorized access removal while retaining the scoped records. I will check the platform-specific behavior instead of assuming disabling an account preserves everything.
- 09 **Leah:** Three acknowledgments are missing. The dashboard colors the whole matter green because most are back.
- 10 **Sam:** That is misleading. An ⁴ _____ is one part of follow-through. It is not a substitute for system verification or a reason to ignore the three outstanding responses.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Leah:** I will follow up through the approved route and tell counsel about any missing person or source. Employees should identify relevant locations without collecting from accounts they cannot access.
- 12 **Sam:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ comes from counsel. If we discover a relevant shared workspace outside the current mapping, we should raise it rather than silently exclude it.
- 13 **Leah:** Can you send the preserved material directly to the other side once the hold is confirmed? That would save another handoff later.
- 14 **Sam:** No. Preserving information does not authorize its disclosure. Collection, relevance and privilege review, and any production must follow the legal team's instructions and permissions.
- 15 **Leah:** Understood. For today's status, I need each source, responsible administrator, action taken, verification result, and any unresolved limitation, with actual timestamps.
- 16 **Sam:** I will provide that record and distinguish a requested setting change from a verified one. If something was already deleted, I will state that fact and escalate recovery options without promising restoration.
- 17 **Leah:** The business expects settlement next week. Should we schedule the hold to disappear automatically on Friday if nobody contacts us?
- 18 **Sam:** No. We need an authorized ⁶ _____. Counsel must confirm release, and we must check for other holds or retention requirements before resuming the relevant deletion process.
- 19 **Leah:** Then the immediate priorities are chat protection, the departing custodian's records, the remaining sources, and the missing acknowledgments, all kept separately visible.
- 20 **Sam:** Agreed. I will send verified status and unresolved risks today. The record will show what is protected, not merely what we have asked people to do.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. preservation | 2. custodian list | 3. deletion suspension | 4. acknowledgment | 5. scope | 6. hold release

An account can close while records remain

F Say it in a new situation

Hold H44 covers relevant email and chat for employee Jo. Jo leaves tomorrow. Email preservation is verified; chat protection is requested but unverified. Counsel has not released H44. Jo's access must end through the authorized departure process.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

chat / release / records / email

10

Coordinator: Verified preservation currently covers ¹ _____ only.

Administrator: The unresolved source requiring urgent follow-through is
² _____.

Coordinator: Ending Jo's access is distinct from deleting Jo's ³ _____.

Administrator: The departure itself does not authorize a hold ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. email | 2. chat | 3. records | 4. release

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Send the right notice

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Distinguish non-renewal, termination, dispatch, and receipt under an explicit notice clause.

Fictional contract: term ends 30 November, otherwise renews one year. Non-renewal must reach notices@vendor.example by 31 October, 17:00 UTC. Internal signatory approval is required. A salesperson received an informal email yesterday; today is 29 October. These are supplied terms, not general legal rules.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Business contract owner | Celia: Contract administrator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Remaining obligations / notice clause / receipt / non-renewal / approval requirement / notice deadline

11

- 01 **Ravi:** I emailed our sales contact yesterday: no additional year. Can you close the reminder, or is something else needed?
- 02 **Celia:** Check the ¹ _____. The contract specifies a different recipient and a receipt deadline. Your sales email is not confirmed compliant notice.
- 03 **Ravi:** We want service through November thirtieth, but no additional year. I am not asking to stop service this week.
- 04 **Celia:** That is ² _____, not immediate termination. The wording should preserve the current term through November without requesting an earlier stop.
- 05 **Ravi:** My department approved the decision. The checklist also requires the authorized signatory's approval, which I do not yet have.
- 06 **Celia:** That ³ _____ remains outstanding. Contact the signatory through the urgent route today; department approval does not cover every step.
- 07 **Ravi:** The notice must reach notices at vendor dot example by October thirty-first at seventeen hundred UTC. Should I enter the end of November as the deadline instead?
- 08 **Celia:** No. The ⁴ _____ is in October. The term end belongs in a separate field. One controls the notice action; the other identifies when this service period finishes.
- 09 **Ravi:** The account manager said they would forward my message. I have no confirmation that it reached the specified mailbox.
- 10 **Celia:** Keep the forwarding assurance as part of the history, not proof of ⁵ _____. We need the approved notice delivered through the specified route and evidence relevant to the actual receipt condition.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Ravi:** What should the formal message identify so the vendor does not apply it to another agreement? We have two services with similar product names.
- 12 **Celia:** Use the correct contracting entity, agreement identifier, intended non-renewal, and current term end, with the approved wording and signatory process. Preserve the final version and its supporting record.
- 13 **Ravi:** I will ask the signatory today and prepare the approved notice. If the email bounces, we should not let the reminder close just because our system says sent.
- 14 **Celia:** Correct. Escalate a failed delivery immediately. Any alternative method or disputed interpretation needs legal review; we should not invent a replacement route and call it contractually equivalent.
- 15 **Ravi:** Once the vendor acknowledges the notice, can I describe this as cancellation with nothing more to pay? Finance is asking about the remaining service charges.
- 16 **Celia:** Not on that basis alone. ⁶ _____ need their own review. Non-renewal is not automatically a fee waiver or confirmation that every account balance is settled.
- 17 **Ravi:** Then the handoff to finance should say current term continues to November thirtieth, with the notice and final charges tracked separately.
- 18 **Celia:** Yes. Keep service continuity, notice status, and any exit duties visible. The business decision and operational offboarding plan are related, but neither substitutes for the notice evidence.
- 19 **Ravi:** I will leave the task open until we have the required approval, final message, delivery record, and confirmation appropriate to the receipt clause.
- 20 **Celia:** Good. We can then record the supported status and archive the evidence without rewriting yesterday's informal email as something it has not been shown to accomplish.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. notice clause | 2. non-renewal | 3. approval requirement | 4. notice deadline | 5. receipt | 6. Remaining obligations

Do not substitute the term-end date

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional terms: current service ends 31 August. Non-renewal notice must reach renewals@provider.example by 31 July at 12:00 UTC. Approved notice sent to that address bounced. No alternative delivery method has been confirmed. The business wants service through August.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

receipt / non-renewal / reminder / 12:00

Owner: The intended action is ¹ _____, not immediate termination.

Administrator: The specified notice deadline is 31 July at ² _____ UTC.

Owner: The bounced email does not establish ³ _____.

Administrator: We must urgently resolve delivery rather than close the
⁴ _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. non-renewal | 2. 12:00 | 3. receipt | 4. reminder

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Contract Intake and Workflow

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which information is missing from intake?

D. Agreement type, business owner, and required decision date

The request lacks routing essentials even though a proposal and earlier nondisclosure agreement are attached.

2. What does the service proposal describe?

A. A two-month software pilot for \$40,000

The attachment describes the proposed pilot, while signature and approval remain unconfirmed.

3. What can Mina do?

A. Coordinate triage and route the request

Mina's role concerns coordination, not the unconfirmed commercial or legal decision authorities.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which acknowledgment is accurate?

D. L17 is received; routing information and required approvals remain outstanding.

Receipt and document presence do not establish review, spending approval, or execution authority.

2. Which question clarifies timing best?

B. What decision is needed by which date, and how does that differ from desired signature?

A specific decision and consequence distinguish the review need from signature, supplier pressure, and an unsupported duration estimate.

3. What should the reviewer receive?

A. The current proposal, referenced terms, party details, business purpose, and relevant data information

The complete relevant package supports review without substituting an incomplete or misleading description.

4. Which distinction is necessary?

A. Requester, business owner, spend approver, and signer may be different roles.

These roles and stages can differ, so authority must be established rather than inferred.

01 Conversation answers

Contract Intake and Workflow

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. intake.** Turn 2. Intake gathers the routing information; receiving an attachment does not establish legal or commercial approval.
- 2. NDA.** Turn 4. The NDA concerns specified confidential information and does not automatically approve the separate pilot services arrangement.
- 3. business owner.** Turn 6. Nell owns the business need, while spending and signature authority still require separate confirmation.
- 4. legal entity.** Turn 8. The legal entity identifies the proposed contracting party; a brand name may not identify that party accurately.
- 5. decision deadline.** Turn 10. The decision is needed on 6 October at noon UTC, separately from the desired 9 October signature.
- 6. review scope.** Turn 12. The review scope must flag the unresolved data handling so an appropriate specialist can assess the actual arrangement.
- 7. version control.** Turn 14. Version control identifies the current proposal and changes; neither unsigned revision should be presented as executed.
- 8. signature authority.** Turn 16. Signature authority must be confirmed separately; legal review does not automatically authorize the requester to execute the agreement.
- 9. turnaround estimate.** Turn 18. A turnaround estimate needs the relevant scope and reviewer capacity; supplier pressure alone does not justify today's completion promise.
- 10. triage.** Turn 20. Triage determines the appropriate route, priority, and next action without deciding the contract's substantive legal or commercial terms.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. unsigned

Coordinator: "The document status is unsigned."

The proposal has not been executed in the supplied record.

2. Dana

Requester: "The business owner is Dana."

Dana owns the need, which does not automatically establish every approval authority.

3. 5 May

Coordinator: "The decision is needed on 5 May."

The review decision date differs from the desired signature date of 9 May.

4. unconfirmed

Requester: "The signer remains unconfirmed."

No authorized signer has been identified, so the requester cannot assume that role.

02 Briefing and language checks

Policy Implementation and Controls

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What triggers the stated H3 preapproval requirement?

A. More than \$100 per guest before commitment

H3 uses a per-guest threshold above one hundred dollars and requires approval before commitment.

2. What is the proposed cost per guest?

B. \$120

Nine hundred sixty divided by eight equals one hundred twenty dollars per guest.

3. What is missing from implementation?

B. An assigned check operator and evidence-retention arrangements

H3 has been published, but the operational ownership and evidence arrangements remain undefined.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. H3 is published, but the control is not yet fully assigned or evidenced.

Publication does not establish operational ownership or completed checks, and H3 uses a per-guest basis.

2. Which event statement matches the rule?

A. The \$120-per-guest proposal requires preapproval before commitment.

The per-guest cost exceeds the stated threshold, and the absence of commitment preserves the required review sequence.

3. Which evidence is most useful?

A. The identified request, calculation, authorized decision, and timestamps showing the sequence

The linked records allow review of both the decision and whether it occurred before the relevant commitment.

4. What does a well-written procedure prove by itself?

D. The designed steps, not that they operated effectively in practice

Design documentation explains the intended process, while operation and effectiveness require separate evidence.

02 Conversation answers

Policy Implementation and Controls

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. control operator.** Turn 2. The control operator performs the defined check; publishing H3 has not assigned that practical responsibility.
- 2. preapproval.** Turn 4. Preapproval must occur before commitment under H3; an after-the-event receipt check does not fulfill that timing requirement.
- 3. threshold.** Turn 6. H3 uses more than one hundred dollars per guest, not a thousand-dollar total-event threshold.
- 4. approver.** Turn 8. The approver holds the relevant decision authority, which is distinct from checking intake completeness and arithmetic.
- 5. control evidence.** Turn 10. Control evidence links the request, relevant calculation, authorized decision, reviewer, and timing to the actual event.
- 6. evidence repository.** Turn 12. The evidence repository provides an authorized location for the linked records under applicable access and retention rules.
- 7. issue escalation.** Turn 14. Issue escalation routes urgency to the designated alternative authority; it does not grant the requester permission to bypass the control.
- 8. control trigger.** Turn 16. The stated trigger concerns one preapproval requirement; other restrictions can still apply below the amount threshold.
- 9. design effectiveness.** Turn 18. Design effectiveness concerns whether the proposed control addresses its objective, not proof that it operated throughout past periods.
- 10. Operating effectiveness.** Turn 20. Operating effectiveness requires evidence that the control actually worked as intended within the relevant scope and period.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. \$90

Coordinator: "The proposed cost per guest is \$90."

Five hundred forty divided by six equals ninety dollars per guest.

2. \$80 threshold

Reviewer: "That exceeds the stated \$80 threshold."

Ninety is above eighty, so the stated preapproval trigger applies.

3. commitment

Coordinator: "Approval is required before commitment."

The fictional rule defines a preventive sequence, not only an after-event review.

4. not approved

Reviewer: "The current approval status is not approved."

No approval is recorded, and exceeding the threshold triggers review rather than automatic permission.

03 Briefing and language checks

Compliance Audits and Evidence

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which period did Talia request?

D. January through March 2026

The request concerns three named historical months rather than the current configuration alone.

2. Which review packages have been found?

B. January and February

The brief states that two packages are located while March remains missing.

3. What does the April screenshot establish by itself?

D. The displayed current setting, not completion of all three historical reviews

A current setting image does not document whether the requested historical activities actually occurred.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which submission description is accurate?

B. January and February packages are available; March remains an identified evidence gap.

The known record availability supports a bounded description, not historical completeness or a fabricated record.

2. Which question best tests the screenshot's relevance?

B. Does this current setting image show that the requested historical reviews actually occurred?

The image shows current configuration; it does not by itself establish historical configuration, completed reviews, or a complete quarterly evidence set.

3. How should a later employee explanation be handled?

C. Label its source and actual date and assess what it supports.

A retrospective account can be useful but must retain its identity and evidential limitations.

4. What does two packages out of three establish?

D. Current evidence availability for two requested months

Record availability alone does not calculate overall control effectiveness or establish the missing month's substantive result.

03 Conversation answers

Compliance Audits and Evidence

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. review packages. Turn 2. The located packages cover two requested months; the March package has not yet been found.

2. timestamp. Turn 4. The screenshot was captured on 2 April, so its current configuration view is not evidence of all earlier review events.

3. review period. Turn 6. The review period is January through March 2026, which determines whether the submitted records answer the request.

4. source record. Turn 8. Source records connect the package to the originating activity and must be checked rather than inferred from a file title.

5. completeness. Turn 10. Completeness is checked against the defined requested items; two located files cannot silently stand for three months.

6. evidence gap. Turn 12. An evidence gap identifies missing support without by itself proving that the underlying March review did not occur.

7. retrospective account. Turn 14. A retrospective account is a later explanation and must retain its actual date and source rather than impersonate an original sign-off.

8. redactions. Turn 16. Authorized redactions protect information while preserving transparency about any effect on the evidence available for assessment.

9. audit trail. Turn 18. The audit trail records the search, sources, changes, and follow-up without altering the original evidence or its history.

10. management response. Turn 20. The management response should state the available evidence, unresolved gap, and next action rather than claim unsupported historical completion.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. April through June

Owner: "The requested period is April through June."

The audit concerns three historical months, not only the current July setting.

2. June

Auditor: "The missing package is June."

April and May are available, leaving June as the stated gap.

3. 3 July

Owner: "The screenshot date is 3 July."

The image's date identifies a later current-state view rather than a June review record.

4. nonperformance

Auditor: "The gap alone does not prove nonperformance."

A missing package does not by itself establish that the underlying activity never occurred.

04 Briefing and language checks

Internal Investigations

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What does Elena say she observed?

A. V19 marked approved while the receiving field was blank

The reported observation concerns an invoice status and blank field, not a witnessed payoff.

2. What is the current status of the suspected motive?

B. An allegation or inference that has not been established

The payoff interpretation is not supported by a witnessed payment or completed review in the supplied facts.

3. What additional concern requires recording?

C. Elena fears adverse shift changes after reporting.

The stated fear concerns possible retaliation and must remain distinct from both the transaction allegation and a proven event.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which intake sentence is neutral and useful?

C. Elena reports seeing V19 approved with a blank receiving field and suspects a payoff.

The sentence preserves the reported observation and interpretation while avoiding an unsupported finding.

2. What should a reviewer do with alternative explanations?

A. Assess relevant supporting and contradictory evidence under the authorized scope.

Fair assessment considers relevant evidence without prejudice or unauthorized evidence gathering.

3. Which confidentiality statement is appropriate?

D. The report will follow restricted authorized handling, but absolute secrecy cannot be promised.

Controlled handling and clear limits are more accurate than absolute secrecy, automatic privilege, or broad disclosure.

4. How should the shift concern be handled?

D. Record it as a separate concern and route it through the appropriate process.

The concern warrants documented routing without a guarantee or a conflicted decision path.

04 Conversation answers

Internal Investigations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. reported observation. Turn 2. The reported observation concerns the invoice status and blank field; it remains attributed until the relevant evidence is reviewed.

2. allegation. Turn 4. The payoff is an allegation, not an established fact or something Elena says she directly witnessed.

3. inference. Turn 6. A blank field does not itself establish nonreceipt; Elena inferred that meaning without confirming the receiving facts.

4. corroboration. Turn 8. Corroboration should come from independently assessed evidence, not from asking another person to align their account.

5. chronology. Turn 10. The chronology should preserve known dates and uncertain times rather than inserting a guess as a precise fact.

6. preservation. Turn 12. Preservation protects relevant existing material from loss or alteration through the authorized process, not unauthorized collection.

7. confidentiality. Turn 14. Confidentiality concerns restricted authorized handling; it is not a guarantee that no other person will need the information.

8. conflict of interest. Turn 16. A possible conflict must be assessed when assigning the reviewer so the concern is not handled through an inappropriate or compromised route.

9. retaliation concern. Turn 18. The fear of adverse shift changes is a separate concern, not a statement that a shift change has already occurred.

10. case handoff. Turn 20. The handoff must preserve the observation, interpretation, unknowns, and separate retaliation concern for the authorized reviewer.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. reported observation

Coordinator: "Rosa's account of the screen is a reported observation."

The screen account is attributed to Rosa and has not yet been independently established.

2. allegation

Reporter: "The suspected personal benefit is an allegation."

Rosa did not witness a personal payment, so the suspected benefit is not a finding.

3. nondelivery

Coordinator: "The blank field does not prove nondelivery."

Missing field completion does not by itself establish whether goods were delivered.

4. unreviewed

Reporter: "The transaction context remains unreviewed."

The relevant context has not yet been assessed, so conclusions about propriety remain premature.

05 Briefing and language checks

Privacy Operations and Data Requests

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What two actions does the message request?

B. Access to information and deletion of contact details

The original wording asks both what is held and deletion of contact details, so the actions must be distinguished.

2. Why is identity clarification needed here?

D. The unfamiliar address and name do not securely identify the relevant account.

The facts create a genuine matching uncertainty, not a universal requirement for a specific document.

3. What should be preserved at intake?

C. The original wording and 1 October 09:00 UTC receipt time

Accurate receipt and wording preserve the request history and support appropriate timing and scope assessment.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which initial response is appropriate?

A. Log both requested actions and arrange necessary identity clarification through the approved route.

The response recognizes the request while addressing the real identity uncertainty and preserving both actions.

2. Which identity approach is proportionate?

A. Request only information needed to resolve the actual uncertainty under the approved process.

Verification must address the present matching uncertainty without a universal document rule, a guessed match, or unnecessary collection.

3. Which timing statement is accurate for this case?

B. The applicable rules must be confirmed; internal routing alone does not establish a paused deadline.

No applicable legal timing rule is supplied, so staff must preserve dates and obtain the correct assessment.

4. What should staff avoid when clarifying scope?

C. Silently turning the combined request into deletion only

Narrowing or changing the requested action without a proper basis misrepresents what the person asked.

05 Conversation answers

Privacy Operations and Data Requests

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. receipt timestamp. Turn 2. The original receipt timestamp preserves when the request arrived; later routing must not replace that history.

2. identity verification. Turn 4. Identity verification must resolve the genuine matching uncertainty proportionately before information is disclosed to a guessed account holder.

3. data minimization. Turn 6. Data minimization limits additional collection to what is necessary for the verification purpose rather than demanding documents by default.

4. request scope. Turn 8. The request scope includes access and deletion; neither should be silently removed or forced into a single action.

5. erasure request. Turn 10. An erasure request requires assessment under applicable rules, including relevant retention duties, rather than automatic deletion of every record.

6. jurisdiction. Turn 12. Jurisdiction and the relevant facts determine which legal rules apply; a remembered training example is not universal timing authority.

7. response deadline. Turn 14. Response timing and any permitted pause require the applicable legal assessment; a clarification message alone does not establish a universal pause.

8. authorized representative. Turn 16. A representative's authority must be established through the appropriate process before treating their instructions as the person's own.

9. third-party information. Turn 18. Information about other people requires the appropriate disclosure assessment; recognizing access rights does not authorize indiscriminate release.

10. request log. Turn 20. The request log preserves the original request, dates, owner, actions, and unresolved questions so the case remains traceable.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 14:20 UTC

Agent: "The receipt time is 14:20 UTC."

The original arrival time belongs in the request history even while identity remains uncertain.

2. address correction

Coordinator: "The second requested action is address correction."

The person asks to correct an address, not to delete all information.

3. identity clarification

Agent: "Before disclosure, the account match requires identity clarification."

The current information does not securely identify the relevant person and account.

4. to be confirmed

Coordinator: "The applicable deadline remains to be confirmed."

No governing timing rule is supplied, so staff must track the request and obtain the appropriate assessment.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which proposed dataset is more detailed about individuals?

D. B's names, work emails, and salary records

B requests person-level identifiers and salary information, while A proposes counts at department level.

2. What is unknown about B's subcontractors?

C. Their locations and access

The brief identifies hosting and support subcontractors but leaves their locations and access unconfirmed.

3. What is the current approval status?

A. Neither vendor is approved.

The scenario explicitly leaves both approvals open pending relevant assessment.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which comparison is justified?

C. B proposes more person-level data and unresolved downstream access, requiring relevant assessment.

Actual data detail and dependencies affect the assessment without proving automatic approval or rejection.

2. What is a useful question about salary fields?

D. Are they necessary for the agreed reporting purpose, and who would access them?

The question connects collection and access to purpose rather than assuming every requested field is justified.

3. How should a questionnaire be treated?

C. As one source to evaluate alongside relevant supporting evidence and gaps

Questionnaire responses require contextual assessment and do not automatically verify controls or confer approval.

4. Who may accept an identified residual risk?

C. The designated authorized decision-maker under the actual framework

Risk acceptance requires defined authority and a recorded basis, not commercial enthusiasm or document receipt.

06 Conversation answers

Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. business rationale. Turn 2. The business rationale defines the needed reporting outcome, which helps assess whether each vendor's proposed inputs are justified.

2. data necessity. Turn 4. Data necessity asks whether each individual field is required for the stated department-planning purpose rather than merely requested by the vendor.

3. data flow. Turn 6. The data flow should identify storage, access, movement, and downstream recipients, including the unconfirmed support access.

4. subcontractor. Turn 8. A subcontractor label does not establish actual activities, access, locations, or the appropriate data-processing role.

5. cross-border transfers. Turn 10. Unconfirmed storage or access locations require assessment; staff must not insert an assumed country to complete a form.

6. inherent risk. Turn 12. Inherent risk still needs assessment of actual data, context, access, and use; department counts do not establish zero exposure.

7. security questionnaire. Turn 14. The questionnaire is a source of vendor claims to assess, not independent proof of every control or an approval decision.

8. contractual safeguards. Turn 16. Contractual safeguards address defined obligations, but their adequacy depends on the actual service, data roles, and applicable requirements.

9. risk acceptance. Turn 18. Risk acceptance is an authorized decision about defined remaining exposure, not permission created by an incomplete intake form.

10. ongoing monitoring. Turn 20. Ongoing monitoring checks material changes after initial assessment, including changes in data use and downstream dependencies.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. access

Coordinator: "The unresolved support issue is access."

The support provider's ability to reach the records has not been established.

2. business purpose

Owner: "We must clarify the service's business purpose."

The required purpose helps determine which inputs and service features are actually necessary.

3. approved

Coordinator: "Neither supplier is currently approved."

The brief leaves both vendor decisions open rather than favoring one automatically.

4. zero risk

Owner: "A site-level-total label does not prove zero risk."

Data context, combinations, access, and other service risks still require assessment.

07 Briefing and language checks

Training, Attestations, and Culture

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does the 98% figure measure?

B. Recorded course completion among 500 assigned employees

Four hundred ninety divided by five hundred measures completion, not every aspect of knowledge or conduct.

2. How many volunteers answered correctly?

C. Eight of twenty

The application check reports eight correct answers in the separate twenty-person volunteer group.

3. What does W4 require for paid weekend work?

A. Disclosure before it begins

The fictional rule explicitly includes weekend work and requires prior disclosure without establishing automatic rejection.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which headline is supported?

B. Training completion is 98%; a separate volunteer check identified an application gap.

The evidence supports a completion measure and a limited separate check, not universal behavior or motive claims.

2. An employee plans paid weekend work. What does W4 require?

B. Disclosure before the work begins

The fictional rule covers weekend paid work and specifies prior disclosure, not an automatic prohibition.

3. What should be said about the 40% application result?

D. It describes eight correct answers among twenty volunteers, with representativeness unestablished.

A volunteer result has a defined scope and cannot automatically be generalized or treated as a causal finding.

4. Which follow-up is most relevant?

C. A clear W4 example, an advice route, and a later check of the same disclosure-timing distinction

The response targets the demonstrated application difficulty and supports questions rather than merely increasing an activity count.

07 Conversation answers

Training, Attestations, and Culture

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. completion rate. Turn 2. The completion rate is 490 of 500 assigned employees, not a verified rate of compliant workplace behavior.

2. assigned cohort. Turn 4. The assigned cohort defines the completion denominator, while missing records and approved exceptions need accurate status handling.

3. volunteer sample. Turn 6. The volunteer sample contains twenty self-selected participants and is not established as representative of all assigned employees.

4. application gap. Turn 8. The application gap concerns whether the prior-disclosure rule includes paid weekend work, rather than course attendance alone.

5. acknowledgment. Turn 10. An acknowledgment records the stated confirmation; it does not automatically prove understanding of every example or compliant conduct.

6. job aid. Turn 12. A job aid can support the task by stating the disclosure trigger, timing, and advice route without replacing the governing policy.

7. role-based training. Turn 14. Role-based training adapts examples to relevant tasks and risks while preserving the actual policy requirement.

8. advice channel. Turn 16. The advice channel gives employees a clear route for questions and should not treat a request for guidance as automatic misconduct.

9. accessibility. Turn 18. Accessibility includes usable wording and format for the audience; a recorded completion does not prove the material was readily understood.

10. follow-up assessment. Turn 20. The follow-up assessment checks the specific timing and outcome distinction rather than substituting another attendance count for understanding.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 95%

Coordinator: "The completion rate is 95%."

Two hundred eighty-five divided by three hundred equals ninety-five percent.

2. fifteen

Adviser: "The number without recorded completion is fifteen."

Three hundred minus two hundred eighty-five leaves fifteen assigned employees.

3. 60%

Coordinator: "The volunteer correct-answer rate is 60%."

Eighteen divided by thirty equals sixty percent for that separate group.

4. representativeness

Adviser: "Generalizing that result requires assessing representativeness."

A volunteer result does not automatically describe the entire assigned population.

08 Briefing and language checks

Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Why was G12 marked complete?

B. The plan was approved on 12 September.

The tracker confused plan approval with the separate closure requirements.

2. What evidence is needed for closure under the stated rule?

B. Implementation evidence and independent verification

The fictional closure rule requires both implementation support and independent verification.

3. What is the status of 15 October?

D. Requested but not approved

Owen has requested the new date, but no authorized extension is recorded.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which 1 October status is accurate?

A. Open and overdue; plan approved, implementation and verification evidence outstanding.

The original deadline has passed and neither closure evidence nor an approved extension is available.

2. What would an approved extension establish by itself?

D. An authorized timing change under its stated conditions

A timing decision does not substitute for execution, evidence, verification, or separate risk authority.

3. Which record should be retained if timing changes?

C. The original deadline, extension decision, authority, reason, and new conditions

A traceable decision history explains both the original status and the authorized change.

4. What should the committee paper request?

B. The specific extension decision and any separate action needed for remaining exposure

A decision-ready paper identifies the actual request and keeps unresolved evidence and risk questions visible.

08 Conversation answers

Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. closure criteria.** Turn 2. The stated closure criteria require implementation evidence and independent verification, not merely an approved remediation plan.
- 2. proposed extension.** Turn 4. The requested 15 October date remains proposed because no authorized extension decision has been recorded.
- 3. status date.** Turn 6. The status date fixes the report at 1 October, when plan approval exists but the original deadline has passed without closure evidence.
- 4. Implementation evidence.** Turn 8. Implementation evidence must show the change actually operating or deployed as required; an unsupported completion percentage cannot replace it.
- 5. independent verification.** Turn 10. Independent verification requires the appropriately separate reviewer to assess the required evidence rather than accept the owner's completion label.
- 6. residual exposure.** Turn 12. Residual exposure describes the risk still present while implementation and verification remain unresolved, not an assumed benefit from plan approval.
- 7. decision rights.** Turn 14. Decision rights determine who may extend timing or accept risk; one approval does not automatically authorize the other.
- 8. action owner.** Turn 16. The action owner delivers the defined work, while risk ownership and authorized acceptance may belong to different roles.
- 9. decision log.** Turn 18. The decision log preserves the original deadline and the authorized change, including its reason, authority, date, and conditions.
- 10. exception reporting.** Turn 20. Exception reporting makes the departure from the deadline and closure criteria visible so the committee can make the actual required decision.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 12 June

Coordinator: "The status date is 12 June."

The report describes the position as of 12 June, after the original due date.

2. open and overdue

Owner: "The current action status is open and overdue."

The due date has passed, closure evidence is missing, and no extension is approved.

3. proposed extension

Coordinator: "The twenty-fifth of June is a proposed extension."

A requested date does not become the applicable deadline before authorization.

4. independent verification

Owner: "Closure also requires independent verification."

The stated closure rule requires verification as well as implementation evidence, not only plan approval.

08

09 Conversation answers

Review the bill line by line

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. engagement terms. Turn 2. The agreed engagement terms set the associate rate at 300 dollars and partner rate at 500; the invoice cannot replace those terms with an unapproved rate.

2. rate adjustment. Turn 4. Twelve hours multiplied by the 25-dollar rate difference produces a 300-dollar reduction; the hours themselves are unchanged.

3. duplicate entry. Turn 6. Counsel has confirmed that one of the four partner hours is duplicated, supporting a separate 500-dollar removal rather than an assumption based only on similar text.

4. revised invoice. Turn 8. The revised invoice is 3,600 associate fees plus 1,500 partner fees plus 150 expense, totaling 5,250, with no tax or discount in the exercise.

5. block billing. Turn 12. Block billing combines multiple tasks in one time entry; this fictional client's guidelines require a factual task breakdown, not invented allocations to make the entry pass review.

6. matter owner. Turn 16. The matter owner holds payment-approval responsibility in the supplied workflow; legal operations checking arithmetic does not itself authorize payment.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 200

Analyst: The rate correction alone reduces the bill by \$200 .

Ten hours times the twenty-dollar rate difference equals two hundred dollars before duplicate hours are removed.

2. 400

Coordinator: Removing the two duplicates at the agreed rate reduces it by another \$400 .

Two hours at the corrected two-hundred-dollar rate equal four hundred, avoiding double-counting the rate adjustment.

3. 1700

Analyst: Eight valid hours plus the expense produce a corrected total of \$1700 .

Eight times two hundred equals sixteen hundred, plus the allowed hundred-dollar expense gives seventeen hundred.

4. approval

Coordinator: Correct arithmetic does not establish payment approval .

The facts leave payment approval outstanding even though the corrected rate and hours can be reconciled.

Background reading: [CLOC: financial management, firm management, and practice operations](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Preserve before deletion

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. preservation. Turn 2. Preservation means protecting the relevant information from loss or alteration; an active email hold alone does not establish that chat and shared files are protected.

2. custodian list. Turn 4. The custodian list identifies the people whose relevant records fall within the supplied hold; names and accounts must be matched rather than assuming one mailbox covers every source.

3. deletion suspension. Turn 6. Deletion suspension stops the relevant scheduled removal within the hold's scope; sending a notice or opening a ticket is not evidence that the technical protection is effective.

4. acknowledgment. Turn 10. An acknowledgment confirms receipt or the specified response to a hold notice; it does not prove technical preservation or resolve missing responses from other custodians.

5. scope. Turn 12. The scope defines the relevant subject, custodians, dates, and sources; uncertainty about another location requires clarification rather than unauthorized collection or silent exclusion.

6. hold release. Turn 18. A hold release requires the authorized legal decision in this scenario; an expected settlement date does not end preservation or override another applicable hold or retention duty.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. email

Coordinator: Verified preservation currently covers email only.

The stated evidence confirms email preservation, while the requested chat setting has not yet been verified.

2. chat

Administrator: The unresolved source requiring urgent follow-through is chat .

Chat is within the hold but lacks verified protection, so the pending request is not sufficient evidence of completion.

3. records

Coordinator: Ending Jo's access is distinct from deleting Jo's records .

Access removal concerns authorization to use systems; relevant records remain subject to the active preservation instructions.

4. release

Administrator: The departure itself does not authorize a hold release .

Counsel has not released H44, and an employee's departure does not end the stated preservation requirement.

10

Background reading: [Federal Rule of Civil Procedure 37\(e\)](#): U.S. background on lost electronically stored information. The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Send the right notice

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. notice clause.** Turn 2. The notice clause specifies receipt at the designated address by 31 October at 17:00 UTC; an informal email to a salesperson is not confirmed compliance with those supplied terms.
- 2. non-renewal.** Turn 4. Non-renewal prevents the next contract term under the applicable terms, whereas ending service before the current term expires would be a different termination question.
- 3. approval requirement.** Turn 6. The supplied internal approval requirement remains unmet; the department's decision does not by itself establish the authorized signatory's approval.
- 4. notice deadline.** Turn 8. The notice deadline is 31 October at 17:00 UTC, distinct from the current term ending on 30 November; using the term end would miss the supplied notice requirement.
- 5. receipt.** Turn 10. Receipt concerns the notice reaching the specified recipient under the clause; an intention to forward or a sent-message record alone does not establish that event.
- 6. Remaining obligations.** Turn 16. Remaining obligations can include the current term's agreed charges and other contractual duties; a non-renewal notice does not automatically waive them or establish a final settlement.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. non-renewal

Owner: The intended action is non-renewal, not immediate termination.

The business wants the current term to continue through August but does not want the following term to begin.

2. 12:00

Administrator: The specified notice deadline is 31 July at 12:00 UTC.

The notice clause expressly sets noon UTC on 31 July, not the later service-end date.

3. receipt

Owner: The bounced email does not establish receipt .

A failed delivery does not show the notice reached the contractually specified recipient, even though a send attempt exists.

4. reminder

Administrator: We must urgently resolve delivery rather than close the reminder .

The receipt requirement remains unfulfilled on the supplied facts, so the task needs urgent follow-through rather than administrative closure.

11

Background reading: [CLOC: practice operations and information governance](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Contract Intake and Workflow

Acknowledge the request: I have received L17 and the attached proposal.

Verify the parties: Which legal entities would enter the agreement?

Clarify urgency: What decision is needed by what date, and what happens if it is delayed?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Policy Implementation and Controls

State the gap: The policy is published, but the check has no assigned operator.

Show the calculation: Nine hundred sixty divided by eight is one hundred twenty.

Separate the decision: Who has authority to approve or reject the request?

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Compliance Audits and Evidence

Confirm the scope: You are requesting the monthly reviews for January through March 2026.

Limit the conclusion: That gap does not by itself establish whether the review occurred.

Check completeness: Let us reconcile the requested months against the evidence index.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Internal Investigations

Acknowledge the report: Thank you for raising the concern; I will record what you tell me accurately.

Attribute the statement: You report seeing V19 marked approved with a blank receiving field.

Record uncertainty: I will mark that detail as unknown rather than fill it in.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Privacy Operations and Data Requests

Recognize the substance: The message asks for access and deletion, even though it uses ordinary language.

State the uncertainty: We cannot yet match the sender securely to an account.

Separate the actions: Access and deletion need distinct assessment within the request.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Acknowledge the benefit: The demonstration suggests B may be easier for the team to use.

Challenge necessity: Which of those individual fields are needed for the agreed purpose?

Avoid a label shortcut: Calling the data aggregate does not by itself establish anonymity.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Training, Attestations, and Culture

Name the measure: Ninety-eight percent refers to recorded training completion.

Report the separate check: Eight of twenty volunteers answered the application question correctly.

Address the example: Weekend work is included in that disclosure requirement.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

State the reporting date: This status is as of the first of October.

Name the missing evidence: Implementation evidence and independent verification are outstanding.

Ask for the actual decision: The committee needs to consider the extension request through its authority process.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

accessibility check training accessibility	60
acknowledgment record policy acknowledgment	59
action owner identify the action owner	68
advice channel identify the advice channel	60
agreement type identify the agreement type	5
allegation record an allegation	32
anonymity distinguish anonymity	33
application gap address application gaps	60
application question design an application question	59
approved extension document an approved extension	69
approver verify the approver	14
assigned cohort verify the assigned cohort	59
assurance report review assurance-report scope	51
attestation obtain an attestation	59
audit right clarify audit rights	51
audit scope confirm the audit scope	23
audit trail preserve the audit trail	24
authorized representative verify representative authority	41
behavior measure define behavior measures	60
business owner identify the business owner	5
business rationale document the business rationale	50
case handoff document the case handoff	33
chronology establish a chronology	32
clarification request necessary clarification	41

Find a term and its context

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CLM maintain the CLM record	6
closure criterion apply closure criteria	68
commitment verify commitment status	15
committee charter review the committee charter	68
completeness assess completeness	24
completion criterion define completion criteria	59
completion rate calculate the completion rate	59
confidentiality explain confidentiality limits	33
conflict of interest disclose a conflict of interest	33
contemporaneous evidence locate contemporaneous evidence	24
contract package assemble the contract package	6
contractual safeguard assess contractual safeguards	50
contradictory evidence assess contradictory evidence	32
control operate a control	14
control evidence retain control evidence	15
control frequency define control frequency	15
control objective define the control objective	14
control operator assign the control operator	14
controller identify the controller role	42
corroboration seek corroboration	32
counterparty verify the counterparty	5
cross-border transfer assess cross-border transfers	50
data flow map the data flow	50
data minimization apply data minimization	42

Find a term and its context

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data necessity assess data necessity	50
data subject identify the data subject	41
decision deadline clarify the decision deadline	6
decision log maintain the decision log	69
decision rights clarify decision rights	68
delegated authority verify delegated authority	68
deletion verification request deletion verification	51
design effectiveness assess design effectiveness	15
detective control operate a detective control	14
DPA review the DPA	50
DSAR route a DSAR	41
due diligence conduct vendor due diligence	50
erasure request assess an erasure request	41
escalation threshold apply escalation thresholds	69
evidence gap disclose an evidence gap	24
evidence repository use the evidence repository	15
evidence request clarify the evidence request	23
exception escalate an exception	15
exception log reconcile the exception log	24
exception reporting provide exception reporting	69
exemption assess an exemption	42
exit plan assess the exit plan	51
factual attribution maintain factual attribution	33
finding substantiate a finding	32

Find a term and its context

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first-hand account distinguish a first-hand account	32
follow-up assessment conduct a follow-up assessment	60
fourth party assess fourth-party dependencies	50
governance support effective governance	68
hearsay attribute second-hand information	32
identity verification complete identity verification	41
implementation evidence verify implementation evidence	68
implementation gap close the implementation gap	15
incident notification define incident-notification duties	51
independence protect reviewer independence	33
independent verification obtain independent verification	68
inference distinguish an inference	32
inherent risk assess inherent risk	51
intake complete contract intake	5
intake note prepare a neutral intake note	33
investigation scope establish investigation scope	33
issue escalation document issue escalation	15
job aid provide a job aid	59
jurisdiction confirm the applicable jurisdiction	42
knowledge check administer a knowledge check	59
knowledge gap identify knowledge gaps	60
KRI interpret a KRI	69
learning objective define learning objectives	59
legal approval record legal approval	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

legal entity confirm the legal entity	5
legal hold follow a legal hold	33
LMS review LMS records	59
localization review localization	60
management response prepare the management response	24
matter open a matter	5
metadata retain relevant metadata	23
mitigation plan approve a mitigation plan	69
MSA review the MSA	5
NDA locate the NDA	5
need-to-know access restrict access on a need-to-know basis	33
ongoing monitoring plan ongoing monitoring	51
onward disclosure identify onward disclosures	50
operating effectiveness test operating effectiveness	15
order form verify the order form	5
overdue action report overdue actions	69
override review control overrides	15
PBC list maintain the PBC list	23
personal data identify personal data	41
plain language explain in plain language	60
policy publish a policy	14
policy owner identify the policy owner	14
population establish the population	23
preapproval obtain preapproval	14

Find a term and its context

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preservation refer preservation needs	33
preventive control design a preventive control	14
privileged access review privileged access	23
procedure implement a procedure	14
processor assess the processor role	42
proportionality assess proportionality	41
proposed extension record a proposed extension	69
provenance document evidence provenance	23
purpose limitation define purpose limitations	50
quorum verify quorum	68
receipt timestamp preserve the receipt timestamp	42
rectification route a rectification request	41
redaction document necessary redactions	24
relevance assess evidence relevance	24
reliability assess evidence reliability	24
remedial learning provide remedial learning	60
remediation track remediation	51
reperformance document reperformance	24
reported observation attribute a reported observation	32
reporter acknowledge the reporter	32
representativeness assess representativeness	60
request log maintain the request log	42
request scope clarify request scope	41
requester contact the requester	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

residual exposure describe residual exposure	68
residual risk describe residual risk	51
response deadline verify the response deadline	42
retaliation concern record a retaliation concern	33
retention obligation verify retention obligations	42
retention period verify retention periods	51
retention rule follow retention rules	15
retrospective account label a retrospective account	24
review package assemble the review package	23
review period state the review period	23
review scope define the review scope	6
right of access assess a right-of-access request	41
risk acceptance document risk acceptance	51
risk appetite define risk appetite	69
risk owner identify the risk owner	68
risk register maintain the risk register	69
risk tolerance monitor risk tolerance	69
role-based training deliver role-based training	59
routing rule apply routing rules	6
sample explain the sample	23
SAR recognize a SAR	41
scenario-based assessment use scenario-based assessment	59
search scope document the search scope	42
secure disclosure arrange secure disclosure	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

security questionnaire	evaluate questionnaire responses	51
segregation of duties	assess segregation of duties	15
sign-off	verify reviewer sign-off	24
signature authority	verify signature authority	6
source record	preserve source records	23
SOW	reconcile the SOW	5
speak-up culture	support a speak-up culture	60
spend approval	obtain spend approval	6
status date	state the status date	69
subcontractor	identify subcontractors	50
subject	identify the investigation subject	32
subprocessor	verify subprocessor roles	50
target signature date	qualify the target signature date	6
terms of reference	confirm terms of reference	68
third-party information	review third-party information	42
threshold	apply the threshold	14
timestamp	verify timestamps	23
triage	triage the request	5
trigger	specify the control trigger	14
turnaround estimate	qualify the turnaround estimate	6
unsigned proposal	identify an unsigned proposal	6
version control	maintain version control	6
volunteer sample	qualify a volunteer sample	60
witness	identify potential witnesses	32

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Corporate Legal Operations Consortium. CLOC Core 12.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on legal operations roles and service delivery. The cases are original and do not reproduce the proprietary maturity assessment. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] U.S. Department of Justice. Evaluation of Corporate Compliance Programs (September 2024).

[Open the original source](#)

United States prosecutorial guidance used as background on evidence and effectiveness, not a universal legal checklist or guarantee of compliance. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] UK Information Commissioner. A Guide to Subject Access.

[Open the original source](#)

UK guidance updated July 2026. The fictional global triage case does not specify governing law; UK clarification and identity-timing rules must not be generalized worldwide. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] U.S. Government Accountability Office. Standards for Internal Control: The Green Book (2025).

[Open the original source](#)

United States federal internal-control background. Fictional private-company controls and closure rules in this book are not universal legal requirements. Checked 10 October 2026.

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